

Aqeedah

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Book: Al Aqeedah Al Tahawiyyah
[The Creed of Imam al-Tahawi: Al-'Aqīdah al-Tahāwīyah](#)

Intro to Aqeedah

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Date Covered: 1/6 @ 1314, 1/7 @ 1310

Preview

- The word aqeedah does not exist in earlier generations
 - Used to be known as Fiqh of Akbar
 - The purpose of aqeedah is gaining an understanding of who Allah is
- Topics that might be discussed
 - Attributes of Allah
 - Balancing an understanding of the Prophet ﷺ as our messenger
 - Allah's judgement of non-muslims
 - The contexts in which conversations of aqeedah appear
 - The morality argument (Allah being the most moral creator and islam being the most moral religion)
- We will also be covering some history that is not found in the book
 - Some scholars might teach this book of aqeedah while acknowledging madhab differences
 - Will also discuss common terminology
- Basic principles of discussion
 - The technicalities are different but the beliefs are the same
 - Not discussing why others are incorrect
 - It's not about establishing one or the other as correct
- What did sahaba do?
 - Ibn Abbas for example explained the hand. Can't say sahaba didn't try to explain things, that would be going backward
 - The sahaba did not ask questions about aqeedah
 - Children asked the Prophet ﷺ, but in general they did not speak about it
- Aqeedah is not an ammunition, it is a shield
 - Sometimes people would come to Imam Malik with bad questions, and he would get angry.
 - A man from Iraq came and asked, does the blood of a mosquito make my clothes najis? He told the man to leave, because he was spewing fitna. Was trying to bait him. He said you did not worry about the blood of Hussain
- Example of an aqeedah matter: Allah's istiwa (elevation)
 - It is well documented in the Quran
 - We know Allah is above the arsh, but how he is above is unknown
 - The sahaba did not ask so we do not ask
 - But to claim that they never asked on any matter is not true
- Example: The eye of Allah
 - Not a literal eye, but showing Allah's watchfulness and observation of us

- How it helps build a relationship with Allah: can be a source of comfort
- Would not be able to derive such a meaning unless we took the metaphorical approach.
- Example: Closeness of Allah
 - Allah could be literally close, but also metaphorically in that his help is near
 - None of the axillary meanings should be taken as definitive though

Early History of Aqeedah

- Importance of knowing context
 - Must know the authors historical context
 - Example: Mohammed Hoblos, who is often shouting, but is talking to youth or actual gangs
 - Need to know the authors audience
 - Context allows one to appreciate the rigor they showed
- The first two generations of muslims did not have these discussion, around madhabs
 - This began with the rise of fitan
 - Fitan brought the need of “securing borders” in all the disciplines (like hadith preservation)
 - Example: The Khawarij, who claimed that major sins had made people kaaafir. Fought fellow muslims by that principle.
- Lesson: Importance of knowing the threshold of islam
 - History: Thousands of muslims killed in Sawud
 - “Khariji sentiments” are these extreme principles which lead to shedding the blood of a muslim. Not at all okay.
 - The Prophet ﷺ got very upset with Usama who killed a man after he took shahada and ask “Did you tear open his heart to check?” Then he said “Oh Allah I have nothing to do with what Usama did”. And this was not because he did not love Usama. The Prophet ﷺ used to give him more stipend than his own son, and other perhaps more deserving sahaba. However he still reprimanded him and became very upset with him.
- Context of Imam Hanbal
 - A fitan emerged: Is the word of Allah a creation or is it a siffa (description)?
 - Allah is never absent from any of his siffas, so if a person were to say the Quran is created it opens a challenge for muslims: creation can be changed, can have flaws. Allah cannot. The Quran then has to be a quality of Allah.
 - In the Abbasid khilafa, the Mutazilites (the ones who were part of the pack but separated themselves “the rationalists”). These people were scholars of other philosophies

- They were able to convince the khalifa Mutazil that the Quran is a creation of Allah. And when the khalifa believes it, it is the truth.
- So then the scholars were summoned and asked. Asked for a one-word answer. Over time the scholars were forced to say that it is a creation.
- Amongst the only scholars who defied this was Imam Hanbal.
- Because of this he served 12 years in prison and was lashed daily for this. And the guards would ask for his forgiveness
- Imam Hanbal was already a big scholar, so if he were to admit the door would be closed. He was the reason we were able to fight this fitna.
- He had holes in his back so big that his son said he could stick his fingers inside. At the end of his life he kept asking for forgiveness for Mutazil
- This idea of oppressing scholars has been around since the beginning
- After 12 years he was released. Now it is confirmed, the Quran is not a creation.
- Then he became very staunch against excessive contemplation.
- He would get very upset when people asked for his opinion. So, qiyas is not used. He would rather say that both views are correct than rationalize and say only one is correct.
- Summary: Imam Hanbal's aqeedah emerged while resisting a fitna and protecting an important truth (the Quran being a siffa of Allah)
- Context of Imam Ashari
 - Was created out of his need to respond to the live debates taking place in his time, also brought up by the Mutazilites
 - It was a necessary movement to protect people from moving to the further extreme.
 - Some things he was responding to: that the siffat of Allah are not intrinsic to him. The mutazzilites argued that Allah has parts. Not true because his siffat are a part of him.
- Ummatan wasata: have a balance of submission and contemplation
 - Most people do not know the difference between athari and ashari
 - At its roots it's just important to recognize the need for balance
 - Don't be the reason why others doubt their religion
- Side Story: Harun Rashid
 - Wife of Harun Rashid hears a big noise outside, she wakes him up and says she thinks hears a coup.
 - Abdullah ibn Mubarak had just returned from Hajj that was the cause.
 - You are the king of peoples bodies but he is the king of peoples hearts
- Caution against speaking against the great scholar
 - We are very small people compared to the people that came before us
 - Ghazali for example is an extremely comprehensive scholar. We should be cautious to criticize them

- Should be careful especially because speaking about them frivolously almost makes us think that we are on the same playing field as them
- Having a lack of respect for the scholars closes our doors to knowledge, we do ourselves injustice

Common Terms

- There are 2 main madhabs in aqeedah
 - Athari
 - Ashari
 - Maturidhi
- **Athari**
 - Hanbalis are historically Athari, because Imam Hanbali is its founder. The principles that he works through are the ones the founders of athari refer back to.
 - They say this is the creed of the sahaba.
 - The biggest difference between the two creeds is methodology
 - Method: Tafweedh. Do not attempt to interpret any aspect of Allah's existence, simply accept it as it is
 - Example: The hand of Allah. Don't try to understand what it is. It is just as how Allah sees it to be fit.
 - The fear they have with taweel is of opening up the door to mistruth. Confining Allah to certain meanings, or straying from the truth like the Christians did, especially since human beings have always tried to imagine God.
- **Ashari**
 - Ashari was founded by Abul Hasan Al Ashhari as a response to athari
 - Method: Taweel. To attempt to understand and scrutinize every detail
 - The majority of the ummah is ashari
 - Example: The hand of Allah. It is however Allah sees it to be fit, but it could have a metaphorical meaning which allows for a person to build a relationship. The hand then indicates Allah strength, power, help, etc. It is not a literal definition but it is a useful figurative one
 - If it wasn't for the Ashari creed it would be very difficult to explain islam to people. Otherwise you would be telling people to believe just because.
 - This is a minimal difference though.
- **Maturidhi**
 - Malikis are more maturidhi
 - Nearly the same as Ashari, but with 11 technical differences

Ch 1: Tawheed (Monotheism)

Chapter 1: Tawheed (Monotheism)

Date Covered: 1/8 @ 1307 - p. 1 of PDF, 1/14 @ , 1/19 @ 1318

Italicized bold is the Arabic text from the original book.

We say about the oneness of Allah, believing in the guidance of Allah, that Allah is one without any partner

- Distinguished from the Christians who believe that Allah has partners
- Marifa of Allah
 - The belief not only that Allah is one but that Allah is the only being capable of guiding, of having total power (all of his siffas)
 - There are people who have studied god more than us
 - Marifa is not through knowledge alone but through the heart
- Sharik of Allah
 - Meaning partners
 - Someone owns 10% of your business, they're called a sharik
 - Even if someone is 1% considered to be god in our life, that is called shirk
 - Not that they give equal deity. But even giving them a share is still under the umbrella of shirk
 - Ghazali says Allah is not Allah because he commanded it, he just is
 - Believing in an authority over you give you a religious compass/goalpost
 - If your heart is giving authority to other things do you have true tawheed?
 - There cannot be partners of any percentage in you heart
 - The greatest way to identify a persons lord is whether they are honored or hurt by its increase
 - Someone's rabb can be family, wealth, etc.

There is nothing like him

- Boundaries of describing Allah
 - The moment someone tries to describe Allah they will fail
 - They can only use descriptions of the creation to exalt Allah
 - They cannot do it to exalt the creation
 - Shaya mithluhu: Cannot compare Allah in any aspect in even the smallest way
- Examples of incomparability
 - Allah's knowledge compared to the creations knowledge
 - Allah's care compared to the creations care
 - The command of Allah over all of his creations

- Other religions compare angels to Allah. Or the prophets to Allah. However these comparisons lack knowledge of Allah's siffas and his command and deliverance over his creations
- Explaining Allah's self restrictions
 - Ex: Allah has made oppression haram on himself
 - When Allah does not do something, it does not mean that Allah is limited
 - Analogy: The mother could strangle her child but she doesn't
 - Sometimes people like to put Allah in this box because they want Allah to be relatable.
 - Allah is not supposed to be relatable. If god was like us, why would we worship him?
- Ways Allah is unlimited
 - Time and space: Humans are limited by time and space. Allah is always in the present, in regards to space and time
 - Awareness and knowledge: There is nothing that is unknown to him

There is nothing that can weaken him

- Strength and security of Allah
 - Allah is khaliq without the need of creation
 - Nothing can make Allah incapable
 - Analogy: Every superhero has something that can weaken him. But nothing can weaken Allah
 - Most often people lose their strength because it relies on something
- Allah is self sufficient and always relied upon
 - Allah does not rely on anything as a source of strength
 - Human beings by comparison will always be reliant on something
 - Example: Health
- Allah can never be overwhelmed
 - His decisions will not be deterred by emotions like love, hate, fear
 - Allah's love is not paralyzing on him
 - Allah's anger is not oppressive, rather is justice is perfect
 - Since he does not benefit from his creation at all
 - There are no delays in his decisions

There is nothing worthy of worship but him

- The word ila
 - Meaning worship
 - The one you turn to
 - No one else worthy

He is eternal without a beginning and enduring without an end

- Absence of a beginning
 - He is the first, but not in comparison to anything else
 - He does not have a beginning
 - All of creation has a beginning and an end
- Absence of an end
 - Only Allah is capable of such a thing
 - Every other creation will meet an end and be destroyed
 - Example: the angels who blow the trumpets
 - There will be a time in Allah's dominion where everything will cease to exist, then Allah will bring them back
 - Some commentators ask if Jannah and Jahannam will be destroyed, or the Arsh. Ultimately we do not know, we just know that Allah could if he wants to
 - The creation also ages

He will never perish nor come to an end

- Arabic vocab used
 - Yafna: Means self destruction
 - Yabid: Means caused to destruct by something else
- Allah's traits cannot be affected by either kind of destruction
- If a person does not believe in a creator then you need to establish it
 - A person who does not have the reference will need it
 - Some

Nothing happens except that he wills

- Arabic terms
 - Yuridu/Irada: intention, will
 - Qada: outcomes
- There is no gap between Allah's intentions and outcomes
 - The reason humans have a separation between the two ideas is because we have the capacity to make mistakes
 - Allah does not have a gap between the two
 - Example: Mufti's son asked his wife, if Allah loves you why are you sick? We wonder why is that khayr (goodness)? Why is that ma yurid (intention)? Allah has a greater purpose for it.
- Lesson: Finding comfort in Allah

- Knowing who is in charge makes things easier. It is much easier to concede to the liabilities of life by understanding that Allah is in charge
- There is no mashiah of Allah's creation that can overwhelm Allah's decisions
- If Allah brings harm your way then no has the power to obstruct it and if Allah brings good to you then no one can prevent it
- Who other than Allah would have the power to bring night and day?
- Allah's qadr is not to be blamed for our own shortcomings however
- Allah's knowledge: Not a leaf falls from a tree except that Allah is aware
- Lesson: Finding wisdom in qadr
 - Free will: Allah has given us free will. It is still our decision to be here or be there
 - Wisdom in difficulty: The challenge is to learn how to accept Allah's qadr in difficulty and recognize that whatever ease we have is not really because of something we did. Every creation of Allah has to go through a phase of tarbiya
 - Ultimate reward: the believers will see in Jannah how Allah protected and guided them
- Answer for all of our grand questions: We don't focus on his being but on his qualities
 - We don't need to understand why or how Allah does things, that is above our pay grade. It doesn't mean we can't, it needs to come with growth
 - Our framework for rationalizing things should be based on his qualities not his being.

He does not resemble any created being

- Tashbeeh
 - Matching up of Allah to any other creation
 - Like how the Christians do: matching up angels to Allah
 - ;Or the Buddhists
- How does Allah manifest?
 - In the form that he is in
 - There is no room for the opinion of tashbeeh
- Boundaries of tashbeeh
 - Do not give Allah jism (limbs)
 - Do not overly interpret Allah "human like" attributes (the eye, hand etc.)

Core Traits of Allah

Core Traits of Allah

Date Covered: 1/8 or 1/14

Names mentioned

Al Hayy
Al Qayyum
Al Khaliq
Al Bari
Al Mussawwir
Al Muhyi
Al Basir
As Sami

He is living and he never dies, always sustaining and never sleeping

- Ismul aadham
 - Whoever used these names there dua to mutajad
 - In a hadith the Prophet ﷺ specified that is it in the beginning of Ali Imran
 - Al hayy and Al Qayyum
- **Al Hayy**
 - Forever existing/ eternally living
- **Al Qayyum**
 - Normally your ability to be efficient declines as your life progresses
 - Not only is Allah only ever living, but there is no dip in his qualities
- Understanding Allah through Al-Qayyum
 - Humans have a prime age. Allah is always at his prime
 - Human beings are always infatuated by excellence and its prolongation
 - Allah never gets overwhelmed
 - Allah does not doze off, he does not get bored
 - He is always completely in control of all aspects of his creation
 - Qa-im vs qayyum: There is no distance in Allah's qa-im
- Allah's qualities are independent from what is happening around him
 - Human beings have been made weak
 - This is in comparison to the creator

He creates without a need to create and he provides for his creation without any effort.

- **Al Khaliq**

- Why did every creation take place since the beginning of humanity?
 - Because we need it
 - There is a need which people try to fulfill through invention
 - Even having children is for the purpose of us, fulfillment
- The purpose of the human being
 - Allah does not need us
 - However the best product is one that functions well
 - Allah says: I did not create you to fulfill and emptiness in me
- Why does Allah create?
 - For human beings: to worship him, to test them
 - For angels: worship (but
 - All other creations: to serve the human being
 - Allah has subjugated other creations for the human being
- Human beings and their responsibility over creation
 - As much as other creations are subjugated for us there is an equal amount of responsibility
- Analogy: child starts to think the parent needs them more than they need their parents
 - However Allah always refers to his deen as himself
 - The one who thinks they do not need Allah and that Allah gains something from submission is due punishment
- Mouna
 - difficulty/ burden
 - Allah does not feel any kind of burden
- There is no burden upon Allah or on the human who relies on him
 - Understanding mouna in hadith
 - The Prophet ﷺ says, if you all were to trust Allah the way birds trust Allah
 - Allah will sustain the human as well
- Example of Suleiman
 - His command over jinns
 - Allah gave him such power
 - The Prophet ﷺ was praying and a jinn started bothering him so he grabbed it
 - He thought about tying the jinn up but remembered the dua of Suleiman AS and decided not to
 - He also had command over animals and could speak to them
 - The whale that came to eat the buffet. Allah feeds me 3x this amount

PDF p3: He causes death with no fear of consequences, and He resurrects without any Difficulty

- Allah gives life without fear of consequences
 - If Allah takes someone's life there is no liability in the eyes of Allah
 - If they choose to send their child to boarding school, we don't have the right to argue because it is their child
 - Allah has no concern for consequences
 - Sufyan at Thawri: I can notice the sins I committed by the way people respond to my salams
- Resurrection without difficulty

How do we respond to the egotistical god argument? That Allah creating us to worship him is not from a place of narcissism?

He has existed with his timeless attributes before his creation which added nothing to his essence that was not already among his attributes. As his attributes were before creation so will they continue forever.

- The qualities of Allah do not come into existence upon the involvement of his creation
 - Analogy to a woman's response to an infant cry. It is a biological response, even if they are not mothers yet they respond.
- Differences between Mathuridis and Asharis
 - The Asharis take the opinion that the qualities always existed (like Allah's mercy)
 - The Mathuridis take the opinion that the qualities are inherent but did not become apparent until they were being used
 - Mutazilite argument is that if the qualities were inherent he would have to rely on them. However this is ingenuous because they are a part of Allah
 - You cannot remove Allah's traits from him, or ascribe a timeline to them.
- The creations did not expose a new quality of Allah to himself
 - His siffat were present and they will continue to be
 - Allah's qualities also do not need a "use"

It is not because he created the creation that he earned the name "The Creator" nor by his making it did he earn the name "The Maker"

- It is not that Allah became Khaliq when he created, but rather that he began that way
 - **Al Khaliq** - the creator. To create without a reference or material. Khaliq is unique to Allah
 - **Al Bari** - the Designer/Maker. To put things together. The assembly.

- **Al Musawwir** - the Fashioner. From soora. Making it beautiful. Allah created us from soora (refer to ayah speaking about Allah creating the human)
- The creation of the human being
 - Allah has defined us as the best of his creations
 - We look at nature but the angels look at us
- Story: Sheikh Hamza Yusuf on AI being Dabba TS 1330
 - MAW went to visit him while they were in the Bay Area
 - He was writing something on his desk
 - He said was writing about the Daaba tul Ard, and that he thinks it is here. Mentioned it was still a loose thought. He thinks it's AI.
 - The fitna of the Daaba might be AI. The actual beast might not be here but the fitn are.
 - Daaba tu kalb... the beast will come and he will speak to people
 - Daaba as a word refers to the footsteps of ants
 - This ayah comes in Surah Naml. Sheikh googled AI + ants, and was shocked to find research around AI being built around ant colony communication. And we know this to be certain from the Quran/Sunnah/Suleiman's story.
 - The sheikhs says AI wants us to be like ants. And even the ants are racist, and the white ants have the ability to fly so they don't associate with black/red ants.
- Marbub
 - Ism mafool
- Summary: just because the creation was not there does not mean the quality wasnt
 - Saying otherwise is like implying they needed the quality to be complete

He has the quality of Lordship without requiring anything to Lord over, and the quality of being the Creator without requiring anything to create.

- Allah does not need creation to complete his qualities
- Allah's being the lord does not dip in any way

Just as he resurrects the dead after they first had life, he deserved this name before he brought them to life. Likewise he deserved the name of the creator before he produced them.

- Similarly, Allah is **Muhyi**
 - We might not have experienced Allah's command over death yet
 - But that does not change the concept
 - It does not need to be manifested for us to believe in it
- It has happened before
 - The resurrection of Bani Israel

- The stories of Isa AS: They would return for a moment, but they would pass away again. They were not actually fully brought back
- The Prophet ﷺ touching an animal
- It will happen in the future
 - With Dajjal
- It may be “happening” now
 - Like the existence of holograms ?
 - There are aspects of this in dunya
- Modern Analogy: Harry Potter's deathly hollows
 - There is a stone which allows communication with the dead
 - And anyone who had the stone ended up killing themselves
 - Dajjal will do something similar, he will drive people to such a point
- Who does it apply to?
 - Plants
 - Earth
 - In its complete meaning: humans and jinn on the DOJ

This is because he has power over all things and all things are in need of him. Every matter is easy for him. He has no need of anything for “There is nothing like unto him and he is the Hearing and the Seeing”

- Faqeer
 - Doesn't just mean poor
 - Originally it means someone who was spying and became paralyzed, now needs support
 - They would say the closest thing to a faqeer is a baby because it needs help with everything
- Lesson: It's easy to feel faqeer towards Allah once people cannot help us. But no, we are always faqeer towards Allah.
 - Ayah: There is not a single leaf that falls off a tree without being reliant on Allah.
 - Story: Hudhud almost got in trouble with Suleiman for not returning. Similarly every creation is reliant on Allah.
 - Allah has created us and guided us.
- Even non-mufalliqa? creation require guidance. Even animals have hidaya.
 - How do animals know not to eat their children?
 - Allah gave them a form of hidaya
 - They were given instincts.
- Side Story: lesson about not falling for Shaytan

- His teacher told him don't have a fish brain. It sees bait and gets caught. Shaytan treats us like fish, uses the same bait he caught our brother or sister with
- Analogy: An expert in their field
 - You don't pay the repair man for the materials but for their expertise
 - Allah is an expert of every aspect of his creation
 - There is no takalluf in him doing anything
- Allah is without need of assistance
 - One of our arguments towards the Christians is them thinking Allah keeps the angels as assistants
 - The mushrik believe that Allah is in need of partner gods
 - We don't have to speak to anyone to speak to Allah
- Clarification - Making dua
 - Its okay to ask others to make dua that is not considered bringing intercessors
 - From the Prophet ﷺ's time we know it is okay to do so
- Laysa ka mithli shay
 - Does not only refer to Allah's dhat but also his siffat
 - Allah's hearing and seeing is not only there but it is the most perfect to exist
 - By comparison the human's seeing and hearing is imperfect. It starts incomplete and it decays too. Between the beginning of life, health and sickness, even coming in and out of sleep.
- Side discussion: the soul in the body
 - Human beings have been created in hastiness
 - The soul starts at the feet
- Allah's hearing and seeing has no deficiencies
 - Allah talks about how he can hear the footsteps of the ant walking in a dark cave
 - He heard Yunus's voice from beyond the 3 darkness in the belly of the whale
 - Nimrud's ignorant statement came from him not understanding Allah's traits
- **Al Baseer**
 - What did ? say to his son? Oh son you could be hiding in a cave and Allah will still bring it to you on the DOJ
 - Allah's basar is such that even if he is looking at something else he is still looking at us.
 - There is no moment where we are not in the lens or frame of Allah
 - His sight is also his control
- Allah sees all, but he may not question us.
 - Allah will not hold us accountable for what it is in our thought and hearts.
 - A man asked the Prophet ﷺ then the ayah was revealed.
 - There are more ayat which speak about this

- Ayat about Allah's sight
 - Darkness does not take us out of Allah's sight
- Modern Analogy: Surveillance
 - Human beings always try to have qualities like god, they strive for things like surveillance
 - They say it is to protect but really its about grasping control
 - Mentions algorithms, how they suddenly start putting it on the feed. They are trying to play god. But only Allah can control it, everyone else is just trying to do the same
 - The moment a human thinks they are in control we know shaytan is
- **As Sami**
 - For the believers this is a comfort
 - Allah tells even the greatest sinners that he is still hearing their repentance
 - Even in the moments of absolute unawareness of Allah
 - How do believers recognize Allah? Through his siffat
 - Why do we tawba? Because we know that Allah is watching

The Egotistical God Argument

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Date Covered: 1/20 @ 1312

Question: How do you respond to the egotistical god argument?

- First answer
 - Someone being egotistical requires them having someone else to compare to
 - Shaytan felt his ego when being compared to the human being
 - In that we argue that Allah is distinct
 - Placing human like traits on Allah is a form of shirk
 - Some argue: Allah is punishing us from a place of ego. Or they might say that Allah does a lot of self praise.
 - There is no need for Allah to take from us.
 - Why would humans enjoy such ease in dunya if Allah truly was egotistical?
- Second answer
 - Allah is self sufficient
 - Our ibadah does not benefit Allah but it does benefit us
 - People can not harm or benefit Allah
 - Allah is not punishing because he was not worshipped but because it is justice
 - Allah is not punishing out of an emotional response to not being worshipped
 - Would it be fair to give someone jannah who lived their best and the same who did not put in the same amount of effort?
 - Nothing can actually increase Allah
 - Ibn Sina says Allah is wajib al wujud. His existence is necessary for everyone else.
 - Atheists, who do not believe in god. They come to the block that something needs to exist in order for everything else to come from it.
 - Since his existence is necessary and everything else is reliant upon him, there is nothing he can actually take from others
 - The creations are simply a small part of his system
- Allah's praise
 - Allah's praise is not coming from a position of ego but of perfection
 - Allah is not seeking praise unworthy of himself
 - He is seeking it by virtue of his perfection over everything
 - Allah's praise is not self indulging
 - You praising him yourself is different from it being demanded of you
 - It's like people seeing beautiful things
- End the discussion by mentioning human limitations
 - Ibn Hazam and other scholars
 - It is not within our capacity to understand that Allah is not egotistical

- When we see power we also see chaos
 - Ghazali talks about how worship is actually for our benefit
- Allah is categorically divine
 - Every limitation that we have is on E
- If Allah was an egotistical god, he would not forgive people
 - If he was looking to use his power, he wouldn't forgive or hide them
 - He wouldn't provide the option of forgiveness
 - Narcissists have trouble forgiving
 - If Allah took the approach of "How dare you" is a fair one to take but it's not the one he took
 - Allah is all knowing but he overlooks
- If Allah did not deliver punishment he would be unjust
 - He is all merciful and yet he punishes, because he is just
 - If he were to forgive everyone he would be unfair
 - These cannot be qualities of an egotistical god
- We were created for the purpose of being recipients of Allah's blessing
 - Allah wants to take care of us
 - He is our caretaker
 - If he created us and then left us to our own devices then that might be egotistical
 - Allah created us to worship based on the fact that it is his karam upon us
 - Our purpose in life to receive Allah's blessings and express gratitude
 - A person who is egotistical will never give back
 - Allah is the opposite, he continuously gives
 - Allah also created us so that he could honor and dignify us
- Final reminder: Allah loves his creation more than any of us love each other
 - We might look at a parent disciplining their child thinking why are they doing that. But then we step back and think, the parent loves their child the most and they know what they are doing.
 - If it wasn't for Allah's punishment why would people act well? His punishment is a form of his mercy
- Ibn Sina says if Allah had not warned us about his punishment we would come to him on the DOJ asking why he didn't tell us
 - Analogy: someone in court pursuing a plea deal. If the lawyer does not correctly present the plea deal to the defendant, it could cause a mistrial. The judge always asks do you know your sentencing guideline?
 - Allah does not keep us in the dark. Not knowing the punishment would be unfair
 - Even the punishments of dunya are unfair. It is a form of tuhoor (purification) of one's sins

- Why did Yaquub AS respond the same tone for Benyamin as Yusuf? Same loss. And because they made their father suffer.
- Even the idea of hardship is rahma
- Allah's acceptance of repentance
 - The concepts of kaffara and hudud
 - We don't have them. Our expiation of sins is in our tawba.
 - The woman who threw stones. Repentance is a definitive form of forgiveness in dunya
 - We have so many routes and options for forgiveness
 - But a narcissist would never do that
- Reminder: Practicing caution in engaging in such conversations
 - Not asking questions which could put doubt people
 - Sometimes people ask these question specifically to drive people who are weak in their faith away
 - Abu Hanifa stopped debating because of this

Qadr

Qadr

Date Covered: 1/20 @ 1345, 1/26 @ 1324, 1/27 @ 1315

He created the creation with his knowledge

- Everything was planned and no creation was accidental
 - There were no mistakes, no trial and error process
 - Most inventions are accidental
 - However Allah created everything with a specific purpose, and every creation is also similarly aware of its own purpose
 - Analogy: Robot that corrupts its own algorithm and becomes conscious. The creator doesn't fully understand its creation
- Allah did not have to work or struggle for the act of creation
 - His irada is a qadiya (decision)
 - Allah doesn't go through a decision making process or a learning process

He decreed destinies for them

- Qadr
 - Precision: every aspect of my existence was written
 - The measurement of my rizq from Allah is also perfectly decided
- Balance between qadr and free will
 - Where is the balance between us being robots and making our own decisions?
 - We must understand free will to also understand qadr
- The Mutazilites (specifically jabariya) take the opinion that human beings do not have free will
 - The benefit of this belief is them thinking that they are not accountable for their sins.
 - They argue that there will be consequences in dunya but not in akhira
- The qadriyas say, we have complete free will
 - That everything that is written for us is not consequential
 - This is also problematic because it takes away Allah's power
- The inbetween party: Ahlul sunnah wal jamaa
 - They agree that a human being possesses limited free will
 - What does that actually look like?
- Ali RA asked this question to the Prophet ﷺ: If Allah has already written for us why?
 - Why wouldn't we just ride it out?
 - Every person will find that in their life they will be attracted to/find accessible the things they were made for in life

- Meaning, if haram feels easy for you, you should change your environment
- The conversation between Musa and Adam
 - How do you know that I ate from the tree? Musa says the book, which was written.
 - Adam asks how are you going to blame me when it was written?
- In another hadith the Prophet ﷺ drew lines and said these things are determined
- Amongst the reasons for free will
 - Liability: being accountable for both good and bad
 - Whatever Allah has documents for us is perfect, however the human being is not aware of this
- Analogy: Road with 7 paths.
 - Allah knows which path you are going to take
 - But which road you take is your decision
 - Allah knows but his is not choosing for us
- Analogy: A parents awareness of what their child will do
 - The ability of doing or not doing is within our scope
 - Ibn Hazam comments that the knowledge of Allah is not compulsion, it is just so perfect that he is fully aware
- No one else knows about qadr except Allah
 - Even the angels do not know
 - The angels are writing them down if they know?
 - We can't be held liable until we act
- Qadr understood through the analogy of the environment
 - Who is making our decisions for us in this country? How much of what we are doing is actually our own free will?
 - Allah having predetermined patterns for people does not completely remove our free will
 - Another example. Parents who are doctors, raising their children talking about their careers. Their child chooses to also become a doctor. How much of that is actually their own free will? Ultimately across the variables we come back to the same answer of the influence of Allah
- More
 -
 - What are the boundaries of our ownership over our own actions?
 - The concept of hidaya fitting into qadr
 - What was written for a person does not qualify them to do it
- How do we understand free will when Allah's qadr intervenes?
 - They continue writing when people die. What the possible trajectories are
 - Khidr's explanation to Musa was such but Allah did make the decision based off of that factor
- How much of our limited free will, if it all, can you relinquish to qadr Allah?

- All of it
- That was the submission of prophets
- Complete submission
- Its actually very empowering to know that we are not in control
- It can make it easier to get through
- Analogy: knowing exactly what your close friend is going to pick between two options

He set for them life spans

- Ajaal
 - Meaning time of death, everything that is numberat
 - Related hadith: the soul and the lifespan set after 40 days in the wombs
 - There are technically 3 types of Qadr

3 Types of Qadr

1. Qadr Al Am
 - The greater qadr for all things in the universe
 - This is general, and it includes the timing of specific events
 - Like the "directors cut"
 - It is perfect, in terms of its flow
 - Question: How detailed is the first cut?
2. Qadr Al Haya
 - The qadr of each individual, which is established for every soul in the wombs
 - Analogy: pulling from the archive
 - The qadr is not being rewritten, just re-established
 - Exceptions exist
3. Qadr Sinawi
 - Laylatul Qadr, the night where Qadr is established every year
 - Your yearly decree being re-established
 - If you understand this, you realize there are stages and there are fulfillers of Qadr. The angels
 - The angels responsible for you are your specific qadr
 - For example if your rizq is less, the angels will make sure that you receive it
 - Angels are not given absolute knowledge, only as much as Allah chooses to give
 - It is like the detailed report version
 - Analogy: corporate has a birds eye view and then they will give you a goal. And a sign of a good institution is that the plan is fulfilled

Mudran: Qadr that Does not Change

Variable 1: Time of death

- The reason it does not change is because it is already perfect
- While the time can never be changed, the type of death can
- The power of giving death belongs to Allah alone
- The concept of “lengthening” life
 - Hadiths that taking care of your parents will lengthen your life
 - Referring to barakah
 - Applies to non-muslims too
 - The rules of dunya do not change for muslims and non muslims
- The concept of dua affecting qadr
 - In the ilm of Allah it was already decreed this way but in the ilm of angels it changed
 - The change is happening but it was known already
 - Dua has a power of actually altering your decree
 - The decree of life is something we have to be comfortable knowing Allah has already made for us
- Related name of Allah: Al Mumeet
 - Allah is the only who give a thing that has life death
 - Part of the reason why the variable of death cannot be changed in its timing is part of acknowledging Allah’s power
- **Variable 2: Time**
- **Variable 3: Jannah and Jahannam**
- The ability to be decisive regarding our fate is a blessing from Allah
 - If we had too much ability to change we would be constantly regretful
 - Imagine you were in control and something went bad, you would never be able to forgive yourself
- Is there a concept of “karma” in islam?
 - We in islam do believe in reciprocation
 - But we do not have to fully accept or reject this concept
 - It is not a binary
 - You see it throughout history, that a person receives something from Allah as a reward for the good they did
- The concept of cause-effect
 - Rather than karma, it is cause-effect
 - And that cause-effect is not external from qadr but a part of it
- The concept of elevation of ranks
 - Even prophets experienced pain and sickness, was it necessarily to forgive their sins? No, rather to elevate their ranks
- The theory of Ghazali and Razi is that qadr can actually change on the daily

- Sometimes the angels will notice that a person committed a sin that was not originally written
- The angels do not have complete knowledge
- They also do not have the same level of understanding of our realm
- The concept of varying accesses of different creations
 - Angels have knowledge of the heavens that we do not
 - Jinns and humans have knowledge of dunya
 - Jinn have more knowledge but do not have the same amount of uns (feelings) as us
 - If angels had more knowledge they probably would not be as obedient
- The concept of varying accesses within human beings
 - Such as that given to prophets
 - People are given knowledge based on qadr too
- How much of our hisaab is already written in our qadr?
 - Follow up Is our akhirah not written in our qadr?

Imam Razi's 3 Tiers of Free Will

1. The ilm of Allah is perfect
2. The ilm of angels is not perfect
3. The human being makes their own decisions

Appearance of Qadr in Hadith

There's only hadith where sahaba asked about this topic. They were arguing with each other about free will. Mashiya of Allah, meaning that Allah gave us a choice. The Prophet ﷺ heard them arguing and said the Quran was not revealed to argue with each other. Qadr is above our understanding and it is Allah's decree.

Summary and Reminders

- 1: We believe in both determinism and free will.
 - Islam will not deny the determinism theory
 - Every decision you make is influenced by things that are out of your control, like genetics, environment etc.
 - Example: picking between ice cream flavors. Influenced by your sense of taste, which flavors are available etc.
 - But that does not mean that you do not have choices
- 2: Its important also to not get caught up in oversimplified questions.

Nothing was hidden from him before he created them. He knew what they would do before he created them.

- Analogy: Like a mother knowing how her children will want something
 - Just because Allah knows us perfectly doesn't mean he is making all the decisions for us
 - Allah does not control our actions but he knows it

He commanded them to obey him and he forbade them to disobey him. Everything that occurs is according to His decree and will. His will is always accomplished. The will of the servants is only what He wills for them. Whatever He wills for them comes to be, and whatever He does not will for them does not come to be.

- If we were not conscious we would not be able to obey or disobey him
- Arabic terms used
 - Qadr means decrees
 - Irada means intent
 - Mashia means will
- A person can have irada but not mashia. But Allah has both, his irada and mashia are not separate
 - Allah cannot even think outside of it
 - Referring to the will to bring things into existence
- Meaning of the word muslim
 - On the scale of ifaal, aslama means continuous submission
 - We are always in a state of submission to Allah
- Mashia (will) is given to the human by Allah
 - Analogy of the parent putting their child in a school
- Who is allowed to ask "why?"
 - A person of knowledge
 - A person of authority
 - Out of love
 - Asking why of Allah ?

He guides whomever He wills. He protects them and secures them as grace. He leads astray whomever He wills. He humiliates them and He puts them to trial in justice.

- Hidayah

- The greatest blessing is hidaya
- If it weren't many reverts would not be muslim
- You can find in the flow of their decisions what led them to be a murtad
- Limitations of human capacity
 - There are certain things that are limited to us by khilqa (the nature of our creation)
- Limitations in decree
 - But there also things that we cannot do simply because Allah has not written it
 - If we had written our own decrees it would only be considerate of the kinds of lives we want to live and not anybody else
 - But when Allah is writing the Qadr he is writing it for every moving piece
- If anyone else had the decision of who to give hidaya to, there would be no justice
 - Allah says to Musa, I chose you
 - People gain so much confidence in dunya from being picked
- Reminder: we do have to make an effort for it for ourselves and for others

Hadith of the Man who Saved Buried Girls

The sahaba who asked, do my good deeds from before I became muslim count? The narrator mentions it seemed like he was let down. The Prophet ﷺ asked what he did that he was so eager to be rewarded for. I heard a baby crying then I heard shovels, and my heart was softened. I wanted to take the baby but they said no. Please let me take the girl. I will give you all of my camels and merchandise. So I took the girl and I raised her. I have saved more than 90 girls. The Prophet ﷺ had tears coming down his face. Because of this Allah gave you hidaya. When the man heard this he said, this is enough of a reward for what I did.

Ibn Abbas on the 5 Effects of a Good Deed

1. Noor/ Radiance on a person's face
 - You did the deed but Allah gave the effect
 - With every good deed Allah puts noor in the heart
 - Dua given by the Prophet ﷺ: Oh Allah put light in my heart, behind me, in front of me, etc...
2. Himma/Strength
 - Good deeds bring himma
 - Quwwata fil badr. Abu Bakr shins were once made fun of and the Prophet ﷺ said they would be heavy on the DOJ. Ali said Abu Bakr was the strongest because he carried the Prophet ﷺ up Ghar Thawr.
 - Strength both literally and figuratively comes from good deeds

3. Tawfiq

- Doing a good deed leads to more tawfiq
- One of the signs of an accepted deed is that they are able to continue doing it

4. Barakah

5. Their love in the hearts of people

- They become beloved to all

● Adil and Karam

- Meaning justice and generosity
- If you do not fulfill the right of something Allah will take it away
- Things are given to people as a test
- All things are moving back and forth between his Adil and his Karam
- Allah's justice does not mean that Allah does not love to give

Allah's Will

Allah's Will

Date Covered: 1/25 @ 1325, 2/2 @ 1315

Nothing was hidden from him before he created them. He knew what they would do before he created them.

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- 5. Their love in the hearts of people
 - They become beloved to all

All of them go back and forth by His will, between His grace and His justice

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He is Exalted beyond having opposites or partners.

- Shaytan's motivation
 - Shaytan is motivated to convince us there are no binaries in our existence
 - This is one of his top goals
- Allah definitively has no equals and no partners

None can repel His decree, amend His judgment, or overpower His Command.

- Muaqqiba
 - Meaning to push away, repel
 - Referring to the lack of capacity to change Allah's decree

Regarding Allah's Sharh

- People wonder, why did Allah decree evil and punishment?
 - In the same way that Allah allows free will to exist, there is also an impact of our choices
 - If Allah stopped sharh, this dunya would be jannah
 - We have a very limited scope so we cannot understand Allah's diving planning
- Allah observes it, he does not facilitate it
 - He can stop it but he chooses not to

- Not within our understanding
- Does islam accept Shaytan being the origin of evil in their doctrine?
 - No, that is a biblical narrative
 - Shaytan is only two things: and adu (an enemy) or a wali (a friend)
- Why are some people given something when they have the potential to do harm by it?
 - Allah's adil cannot be used against Allah, you cannot use the logic of why you did not receive something against someone else
- Can Allah will something that is against Quranic morality?
 - No. On the surface it may seem like it but as a believer we have to accept the uniqueness of certain commands of Allah's
 - Example: Ibrahim AS leaving his wife and son in the dessert
 - Example: Khidr killing the boy
 - Ibrahim AS's life is full of commands that do not make sense, but they do not take away from the fact that Allah's system is perfect
 - Every commandment of Allah is either intrinsically moral or it leads to something that is intrinsically moral
 - Allah would not give a command that is devoid of wisdom
 - Involved concept: submission of the mind, where your mind then would lead you towards believing the command is right. This is what the hunafa were, their minds were already inclined toward submission to one god
 - Additional reminder We don't base the normal nidham of Allah based on his miracles
- How do we process Allah's will for people to be in ignorance? For example, tribes of people who technology and the message of islam has never reached?
 - Their aql is still their strongest source of judgement
 - A person always has the ability to decide for themselves
 - If they don't have aql, they will not be held liable
 - Marfu bil qalam "The pen does not write for them"
 - Nothing is documented with them and they have no hisaab
- For people who are on the spectrum but understand to and extent
 - Those people still have aql
 - They do have a hisaab

We believe in all of this. We are certain that it is all from Him.

Ch 2: The Seal of Prophecy

Ch 2: The Seal of Prophecy

Date Covered: 2/2 @ 1341, 2/3 @ 1315, 2/4 @ 1320

Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him, is His chosen (initially translated as "servant" changed) ***slave, His selected prophet, and His Messenger with whom He is well pleased.***

- Abd
 - Meaning slave
 - We have chosen to be Allah's slaves
 - It is the highest position we can possess
- Mujtaba
 - Meaning selected
- Nabi vs rasool
 - Both hold the same rank and are technically the same in responsibility
 - They are both chosen by Allah, have a responsibility to guide them
 - But a rasool may have some additional characteristics
 - Nabi are not inherently less, but rasool is a higher attribution

Defining Traits of a Rasool

1. A nabi who was given a book/scripture
2. One who was sent to a disbelieving nation
 - When Musa AS was sent to Bani Israel, they were a disbelieving people
 - When the Prophet ﷺ was sent, same thing
3. Given a new sharia
 - They bring with them a new set of rulings and legislations
 - Musa, Isa, The Prophet ﷺ brought sharias which abrogated the previous
4. Given miracles
 - Scholars say the rasool are all given miracles
 - Ex: Nuh and his ship, Isa and his healing

He is the seal of the prophets, the leader of the righteous, the master of the Messengers, and the beloved of the Lord of worlds.

- We believe the Prophet ﷺ is the seal of prophets
 - He is the seal and he is also the khatim
- Khatim/khatam
 - Meaning the final

- Referring to the Prophet ﷺ is the last prophet ﷺ
- Sayyid
 - A word used to show honor and respect
 - Adding the word sayyid in places the Prophet ﷺ didn't use it
- Habib
 - In the pattern of faaeel, but takes the meaning of a mafool
 - Means beloved
 - See below

Verbiage of Friendship

Within the verbiage there are levels, in order of weakness to strength

1. Sahib - the companion
2. Wali - the close friend
3. Siddique - the intimate friend
4. Rafiq - a soft kind of friendliness
 - A person who always has a soft touch to them
5. Habib - a beloved
 - In verbiage it is lower than khalil
 - The one who doesn't ask and is still given
 - One who knows your needs before you ask for them
 - The Prophet ﷺ never asked Allah to open his chest
 - Or to get an elevated rank in his name
6. Khalil - a very close friend
 - The love is through something else, specifically in the context of Allah
 - A person who is khalil of Allah asks and is given

Every claim to prophecy after him is falsehood and deceit

Words for Misguidance

1. Dhalla
 - Means misguidance
 - The person knew where they were going but became misguided
2. Ghawa
 - Absence of guidance
3. Hawa
 - Originally meaning wind, or falling
 - A person who falls, depreciates in the eyes of Allah and people
 - Particularly when gathered together

- This is a fundamental point of our aqeedah
 - If it were not a fundamental point of our aqeedah we would have never waged war on the false prophets like Musaylama
- When other roles wrongly take the authority of a prophet
 - The Ismailis for example falsely believe in Qadiani being a prophet
 - Someone asked Mufti Taqiani, why do you have so many ? He answered because an ignorant audience is a good audience
 - When something can't be defeated, it is attacked by planting seeds of doubt
 - When Qadiani came to fame, it was actually while resisting the British
 - He soon after claimed himself to be the Mahdi, and after that a prophet, and after that Isa AS
 - His full name was Ahmed Mirza Qadiani
- Side Story
 - Huge fan of Mufti's brother, this one family thought he was the Mahdi
 - Their teacher told them the Mahdi would never come from America
- No one is perfect except for prophets
 - Only prophets have unlimited concessions
- Modern example: history of the Qadiani movement in PK
 - Allama Iqbal, great scholar
 - Started supporting this guy
 - Later did tawba
 - Went public and denounced his support of him
 - Khatim an Nabuwa movement came about in PK
 - Court case where a muslim girl married a Qadiani man
 - Until the 70s there was a belief that Qadianis were muslim
 - Supreme court of pakistan ultimately proved that Qadianis are not muslims
- Moral of the story: believing in a false prophet takes you out of the fold of islam
- Modern example: Shias
 - In some countries, like PK, being Shia means believing their Imam is a prophet
 - Very important to clarify living here in America, where things are different

Qualities of a False Prophet - TS 1400

1. They attempt to abrogate verses
 2. They claim to be masum (sinless)
 3. They claim to experience a form of wahi/revelation
- Political or social agendas

- Example: Nation of Islam. Had the motivation of political and social stabilization. It was effective too. Referred to as “nation” people. Many ended up reverting to islam.

Understanding Shia Creed

- Regarding shias
 - There are twelvers ? and within them there are two types
 - They say Imam, but they attribute prophet-like qualities to them
 - Their origin in attributing Ali RA to prophethood: hadith in which the Prophet ﷺ tells Ali he is like Harun to Musa
 - Not within our creed. Even Isa AS, when he returns, will be considered a part of our ummah
 - However we should not look for ways to remove them from our creed
 - There are major issues in the creed of shias which do not take a person out of the fold of islam
- Shia origin
 - Started with a jewish munafiq, 100 years after the Prophet ﷺ
 - Karbala being a major stain on our history has led to the rise of their group
 - Issue: their framework of reverence and love. Over veneration, to the extent where they kiss the hands of their scholars.
 - Issue: Swearing at or cursing companions.
 - Issue: Removing the rank of ummahat al muminin
 - Does not make them kaafir
- Hassan and Hussein
 - Hadith: The Prophet ﷺ was seen by Abu Bakr with Hassan and Hussein riding on his back. He said what a beautiful ride, and to that the Prophet ﷺ responded what beautiful riders.
 - Anas ibn Malik said I did not see a single spot on Hussein’s face that the Prophet ﷺ hadn’t kissed
- Tafdeeli shias
 - They just have a greater respect for Ali RA
 - Not an issue
- Main issue to look for
 - Believing in prophets after the Prophet ﷺ
 - Disapproval of other sahaba
- Common points they bring
 - Their issues with Umar RA. The gardens of khyber.
 - The wives and their inheritance
- The wives were given a small share by the Prophet ﷺ
 - This allowed them to never have to ask another man for financial support

- The Prophet ﷺ also had a small share for himself
- The debate was whether or not it would go to Fatima
- That is when Abu Bakr RA shared the hadith that prophets do not give inheritance
- They find ways to dismiss it

He has been sent to all of the jinn and the entirety of humanity with truth, guidance, light, and illumination.

- The Prophet ﷺ was sent to all of creation, not just human beings
 - All of the creatures, including jinn, plants and animal would look to the Prophet ﷺ
 - Some prophets only came for families or tribes, while others were sent as supporters to other prophets
- Uniqueness of the Prophet ﷺ's messengerhood
 - The Prophet ﷺ was sent without partners
 - To be the messenger until the end of time
- Noor
 - Meaning internal light
 - Used to refer to the moon for example
- Dhiya
 - Meaning external light
 - Used to refer to the light of the sun
- Noor used in different contexts will take different meanings
 - Related to nar meaning fire



Ch 3: Quran is Uncreated

Ch. 3: The Quran is the Uncreated Speech of Allah the Almighty

Date Covered: 2/9 MISSED

Ch 4: Seeing Allah in Jannah

Ch 4: Seeing Allah in Jannah

Date Covered: 2/10 @ 1326

The vision of the people of Paradise is true, without being all-encompassing and without modality. As expressed in the Book of our Lord, 'Faces on that Day will be radiant, looking at their Lord, The explanation of this is as Allah Almighty intended and knows.

- Regarding sight of Allah
 - The Mutazzilites are of the opinion that we will not be able to see Allah, because seeing him requires eyes which can handle seeing him. We do not agree with this
 - We acknowledge that in dunya it is not possible. Ex: Musa unable to handle his noor
 - The realm of akhira is different. That is the entire reward of Jannah
- Proofs
 - Hadith: Those who live as if they can see him
 - Hadith: Are you pleased? And then seeing the face of Allah, then Allah will expose himself
- Allah on the DOJ
 - Allah will expose himself but people will not be able to see him because of their fear
- Allah in Jannah
 - The fear will be gone, and it will be a sight of love
 - One person asked how people will be able to see Allah with so many others around. The Prophet ﷺ it will be like looking at the moon
- Analogy
 - Analogy: Driving knowing the cop is right next to you
 - "Can the compensation of ihsan be anything other than ihsan?"
 - Mufti mentions that this is one of his favored interpretations
- Without kayfiya
 - Kayfiya meaning how
 - We do not know how it will be or how it will look
- Faces turning
 - Nadhira meaning looking with love and passion
 - The explanation of this is whatever Allah intends of it
- Why would the Mutazzilites deny this?
 - Their idea was that if they couldn't rationalize it they couldn't accept it
 - That was the structuring of their beliefs

Everything that has come in authentic narrations from the Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, is as he said and it means what he intended. We do not insert our own opinions in it, nor do we imagine it according to our whims.

- Not doing kayfiya or taweel of the Prophet ﷺ's words
 - We do not insert our own opinions, we do not do taweel on it
 - We limit our opinions on how this will be conceived
 - Ex: Allah will say salam to us. Kayfiya is asking what tone will he say it in, what voice will be used etc.
 - If we rely too much on kayfiya we push to a different end
- Allah's existence as an entity
 - There are even ayat in the Quran which talk about sitting with Allah and being fed by his hands
 - Some people Allah will look at while other Allah will not. Specifically referring to a gaze of karam
 - Allah is a singular entity and not an idea or a concept either, cannot take an excessively figurative meaning of this. There will be a literal sighting of Allah
 - Ila means that you are an entity, Allah is not a thought
 - Athari vs ashari

For none is safe in his religion except those who surrender themselves to Allah Almighty and to His Messenger, and relinquishes the knowledge of what is ambiguous to the One who knows it.

- None of us is safe until submitting to the Prophet ﷺ and Allah
 - The one who submits to Quran and hadith is safe
 - Even if it doesn't make sense to you
 - We believe in faith without sight, belief without understanding
 - If knowing the details of things was a condition of belief, why would we believe in science? Nothing about science is guaranteed either
 - Example: Science cannot prove the soul. Many years ago they could not prove the brain either, did that mean it didn't exist?
- Mutashabihat
 - Meaning things we do not understand and that we avoid trying to understand
 - There are things we believe happened but that we do not try to explain
 - Example: people being returned on the DOJ, and the earth being stretched

He will veer between unbelief and faith, confirmation and denial, acceptance and rejection. Compulsive, disagreeable, doubtful, and deviant, he is not a true believer, nor a stubborn denier.

Ch 5: Speaking without Knowledge

Ch 5: Speaking without Knowledge

Date Covered: 2/10 @ 1450, 2/16 @ 1315

The foundation of one's Islam is not firm unless it is upon outward submission and surrender to Allah

- Tasleem
 - The base of one's religion will not be established until there is tasleem, meaning submission
- Challenging the faith
 - If you want to challenge something you have to do it with knowledge
 - Can't just do it on the knowledge of your own experiences either
 - Experiences are biased
- The fitra
 - Every person has a fitra which is naturally inclined to the truth
 - Things that don't make sense to a person happen often because of a person's experiences
 - Prophets were sent as shepherds so that they could lead others. The environment and upbringing has an impact
- The prerequisite of understanding
 - The premise of not believing should never be ignorance
 - If you do not understand, you should ask someone who does
 - Islam will never be established in a person's life until they learn how to rely on Allah

Whosoever throws their thoughts toward the knowledge we were prohibited from and is not content with monotheism, his aim of earning knowledge will prevent him from securing the purity of belief.

- Hadhara
 - Meaning throw
 - From the mahdhurat meaning prohibited
- Mahkamat
 - A person who follows theory but did not show it in their mahkamat will fail
 - The questions of the grave are based on a person's amal not their theory
 - It is more important for us to act on what we are already confident on than what we do not know
- This person's clarity will not increase
 - Their recognition of Allah will not be any more apparent
 - Analogy: Splitting a hair
- How then are we supposed to learn about Allah?

- All of these matters: how he looks, speaks etc. are key elements in getting to know someone so how then do we get to know Allah?
- By learning his siffat. Even Adam was taught Allah's siffat
- The Prophet ﷺ and sahaba made dua by calling him by his names
- Knowing Allah is not in knowing how he looks but in the power he has over you
 - Authority is not built by physical attributes but by position
 - Analogy: A boss at work

He will veer between unbelief and faith, confirmation and denial, acceptance and rejection. Compulsive, disagreeable, doubtful, and deviant, he is not a true believer, nor a stubborn denier.

Faith in the vision of the people of the Abode of Peace is not correct for those among them who express it as an illusion or who interpret it with their own limited understanding

- Ru'ya
 - Meaning vision/sighting of Allah
- Taweel of ru'ya
 - Taweel meaning lengthening
 - Doing taweel of anything
 - Taweel of siffat is different
 - Khilaf ar rububiya
 - You are allowed to give emphasis to Allah's traits but not to allegorical things, like his hands
 - You can do taweel on ru'ya but there is an extent to it, because ru'ya does not have objectivity
- Why would it harm to do excessive taweel? Or to believe in ru'ya?
 - There's things that you don't understand, and not understanding them won't harm you
 - Example: the mechanics of your car
- "We believe in it" is all you need to know
 - There are many scholars who say this conversation, about Allah's siffat, is already too much
 - Ghazali says no, we should talk about it to understand Allah's greatness
 - However, does that mean a person should speak without knowledge? No. These are conversations led by people already well versed in the foundations of islamic knowledge

As the correct interpretation of the vision, and the interpretation of every meaning related to the Lordship of Allah, is by abandoning interpretation and adhering to surrender. This is the religion of the Muslims.

- Tawakka
 - Comes from waka, brings us to the word taqwa
- Two extremes
 - Mutazzilites: deny such beliefs because it requires attribution to creation. If you believe in ru'ya you also have to believe in how it is going to take place
 - Mujassima: believe in ru'ya of Allah and that it will happen but that he will have creation like qualities (which takes it too far)
- The correct interpretation
 - The best way to do taweel is to hold onto submission

Whoever does not guard himself from negating the attributes of Allah or likening Allah to something else has strayed and has not correctly understood the transcendence of Allah, for our Lord Almighty is described with the attributes of Oneness, qualified with the qualities of uniqueness. He does not have the characteristics of any creature.

- Zalla
 - Meaning slip
 - A person will slip if they have not understood Allah properly
- Criteria of appropriate knowledge: understanding Allah's uniqueness
 - Example: patience. The patience I have with cold coffee is different from the patience of the people in Gaza
 - Similarly, Allah's patience is unique to him. Allah's patience is regarding our disobedience, with our repetitive sinning etc.
 - When Allah carries a siffat we have to recognize that the way he exhibits it is not like how we exhibit it
 - Example: Hilm. A parents hilm is different from Allah's hilm
- We learn about Allah through our own weaknesses
 - We realize Allah's skill level in any quality by looking at ourselves
 - Our deficiencies, even in our good traits
 - Analogy: The quality of mercy is different between a mother and a non-mother
 - Similarly, Allah's mercy cannot be compared to the humans
 - Even animals have mercy upon their children because Allah gave them 1% of it
- Side reminder
 - If you can't show mercy you also can't give it

- If you can't forgive you're not being forgiven

He is Exalted above any limits, ends, supports, limbs, or tools. He is not contained by six directions like the rest of created things.

- Taalal hudud
 - Meaning exalted above any boundaries
 - On the scale of tafaaul (implying 2 parties)
 - How do you recognize boundaries? Things being limited
- Humans are limited
 - They have the most access in terms of potential
 - But they are always trying to be god like (going to space etc.)
 - But their access of unseen is limited, jinn and angels have more than them
- Allah cannot be defined to a space
 - Imam Abu Hanifa was asked which way is your lord facing? He told the atheist light a candle
 - Analogy: light, If there's so much light you can't tell which way it is coming from
- Allah does not have limbs
 - Allah is not qadir because he has hands
 - And he is not sami because he has hears
 - His capacity to do things is outside of the need for limbs
 - Creation on the other hand needs its body and limbs to get things done
- Small tangent: The different schools of thought and how they navigate taweel of limbs
 - People would avoid the ashari creed because they felt it was too similar to mutazzilites
 - Taweel is permissible in a figurative matter, not a literal one
 - If you keep denying the figurative taweel of the hands, you eventually get to tajseem (ex: denying hands leads you to the opinion that you have to be able to recognize the hands for them to be considered hands)
 - Asharis have an appropriate balance
- Allah is above adawat (tools)
 - Allah doesn't need clouds to give rain
 - Allah doesn't need angels either
 - Allah is free from having tools, and this was a mistake of the mushriq who believed that Allah needed idols
 - This mistake originates in comparing Allah to ourselves. We always need tools so we think about Allah through human limitations
 - Allah is ta'ala. Above this.

- Question: Allah not needing to rely on limbs so why do angels have to write down our deeds
 - Answer: Why does Allah create parents? Allah doesn't like chaos. Nidham (system, process) is important. Allah doesn't do things without a process. It is a part of Allah's creations but Allah is not limited to it,
 - When angels write our deeds, they are creating a nidham for us to recognize that it is real. Ali RA used to say he could hear the angels' pens writing.
 - Sometimes in a system you think you are relied upon. But you're actually just a part of the system. If you were removed from the system the system would not fail. Allah can fulfill the duty on his own and even better, but it would be immature of a person to think the system relies upon them
- Allah is not confined to direction
 - The idea of Allah being confined to his arsh is a problematic one
 - No one says that Allah can only be upon his arsh
 - Athari's don't say he can only be there but they do say that he is there
 - How do we corroborate the concept of Allah's descent?
 - They answer that it is through his mercy. They avoid saying that he can figuratively descend to then figuratively interpret his mercy
 - Others says that Allah is not only on his arsh, period
- Related concept: Angels of death
 - Kind of like how there is only one angel of death but he can take multiple souls at the same time
 - Opinion: Angel of death has been given the capacity to take multiple souls
 - Other opinion: Angel of death has his own army
 - If angels have been given this power, imagine Allah
 - How can we limit Allah and his ability to be anywhere?

Sometimes people take advantage of the muslim and their submission to the unknown of Allah to make it seem like blind following. It's easy to see that they are coming from a position of pride and ego. What are some points we can use against that?

Ism tasgeel: the concept of babying. Example: Anas called as Unais, Qarash turns into Quraish. Like calling a small version of the original thing

Ch 6: The Night and Ascension

Ch 6: The Night Journey and Ascension

Date Covered: 2/17 @ 1325, 2/18 @ 1315

The ascension to heaven is true. The Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, was taken by night and ascended in person during wakefulness, to the heavens and then to whichever heights Allah willed for him.

- Israa is the night journey and Miraaj is the heavenly ascension
 - Araaj meaning ascension
 - Why is this topic brought in the books of aqeedah
- Israa is the journey from the Kaaba to Bait Al Maqdis
- We accept that the Prophet ﷺ was awake at this time
 - Abu Jahal's argument was that it was not a true event
 - Abu Bakr responded that if my friend said then it was true

Allah honored him as He willed and He revealed to him what He revealed, 'His heart was not mistaken about what he saw,' Allah blessed him and granted him peace in the Hereafter and in this world.

- Source of ikhtilaf on Israa wal Miraaj
 - Everyone is in total consensus that these two events are tawaatur
 - The sahaba disagreed on whether the Prophet ﷺ met, spoke to, and saw Allah
 - All of the sahaba agree that it took place
- Aisha's opinion: the Prophet ﷺ saw Jibreel
 - The events of Aisha, the Prophet ﷺ went to the heavens but did not actually meet Allah
 - Aisha takes the opinion that the Prophet ﷺ saw Jibreel, not the Prophet ﷺ
 - She was very set in her opinion
 - Would even say whoever claims the Prophet ﷺ saw Allah is lying
- Aisha's reasoning
 - 1: Sight of Allah is reserved for Jannah
 - 2: No one can see Allah, not even the Prophet ﷺ
 - 3: Surah Najm was revealed before the actual journey
 - Her opinion did not create the narrative, the narrative already has prove in the Quran
- All other sahaba's opinion: the Prophet ﷺ saw Allah
 - Reasoning: the Prophet ﷺ saw Jibreel regularly
 - Accepting all of the other details of the narration requires accepting the ending of Miraaj as well

- Evidence in Surah Najm
 - "He revealed to his slave that which he revealed"
 - Aisha's evidence: happened in year 3 AH, whereas lwM took place much later
 - Begs the question: How is the Quran talking about an event that has not taken place yet?
 - Sahaba rebuttal has two answers
 - Option 1: prophecising
 - Option 2: these ayat were revealed later
- Conclusion on the aqeedah of this matter
 - Because we have this disagreement among sahaba, we don't make it a part of our creed that the Prophet ﷺ spoke to/saw Allah
 - If a person denies this, it does not take them out of the folds of islam
- The Prophet ﷺ being awake during lwM
 - Is not something that can be denied (specifically referring to the first incident)
 - One time, narrated by Asma ? The Prophet ﷺ would take a step forward and stick his hand out then move back looking afraid. He said, while I was praying Allah removed the veil between me and akhira, and when I could see jannah I would move forward. And when I saw the flames of jahannam I would step back.
- Side Point: Any opinion that was taken by a sahabi is permissible for us to take
 - This matter has ihtimaal (multiple possibilities), even though it is a minority opinion

The Opinion of Aisha

- Question: How do we corroborate the Prophet ﷺ being awake with the possibility that it happened a second time in Madina in his dreams, while in the company of Aisha?
 - The second event was definitively a dream. Being awake refers to Miraaj the first time
- Question: Is there a chance she was referring to the events of the second time?
 - There is a chance that in her opinion of Jibreel she was only referring to the event that she was present for
 - Variables to be aware of: she was very young, not aware
 - However its also hard to say that Aisha wasnt aware of the first narration, because her role as a scholar, narrator, and wife of the Prophet ﷺ
- Other anomaly opinion of Aishas: That the dead cannot hear from the grave
 - All other sahaba agreed upon all of the narrations of the Prophet ﷺ regarding them hearign footsteps, salams, etc.

- She builds it off the ayat that the dead cannot hear, Surah Ankabut, Surah Ar Rum Ayah 52, Surah Naml
- However these do not decrease her academic integrity
- And sahabas life you open, you will find opinions which are not corroborated by other sahaba
- Understanding ijthadd (reconciliation of differences in rulings) among sahaba
 - They are not prophets
 - They disagreed on many things, even on matters like compiling the Quran
 - Always look at the majority, these two opinions of Aisha's are an extreme minority
 - Not all ijthadds are correct. Sahaba are allowed to be incorrect, its not the end of the world
- Question: Are the opinions of Aisha's a foundation of the criticism shias have against her?

The Journey of Israa

- The Prophet ﷺ was sleeping in the hatim of the Kaaba (or was brought there) and then taken on the night journey
 - There are various ahadith which discuss the night journey
- The ayat of Israa
 - Asraa used in the ayat
 - Implying the beginning of the night
 - Ismun sharaful minhu, the most honorable name of abd is used
- The Prophet ﷺ riding Buraq
 - Smaller than a donkey larger than a mule
 - It is a very humble creature and ride that the Prophet ﷺ was given
 - The purpose was the Prophet ﷺ being undistracted
- In another hadith, Buraq started moving
 - Jibreel hit it, and said calm down there is no one more honorable riding you than the Prophet ﷺ
 - Unclear if it was because it was uncomfortable but because it was excited
 - Animals react physically when they are excited
- The buraqs travel
 - Each step would traverse as far as we could see
- Multiple stops
 - Didn't go straight from Bayt Al Maqdis
 - Stopped at Mt Tur and was shown the grave of Musa AS
 - The Prophet ﷺ mentions he saw Musa standing in his grave and praying
 - He also saw the birth place of Isa AS (Bethlehem)
 - In weaker narrations, he also stopped at Al Nuh-ti

- Purpose of the stops
 - The Prophet ﷺ was being shown signs of Allah
 - The journey of Israa was a journey of conviction
 - The Prophet ﷺ is having his yaqeen cultivated, it is like a journey of prophets
- Context
 - Post am al huzun for the Prophet ﷺ
 - This was a time of peak difficulty
 - This was almost like a reward for the Prophet ﷺ, seeing the path of previous prophets
 - For us, we might not have an Israa but we do have the Quran
- Reaching Bayt Al Maqdis and Jibreel offers 2 cups to the Prophet ﷺ
 - He chose the milk
 - If he chose the alcohol, it would not have made it halal but it would have made it ok for the ummah to make such decisions
 - The Prophet ﷺ choosing milk is a sign of them choosing knowledge
 - In dreams milk usually symbolizes knowledge or wealth
- The Prophet ﷺ tying the Buraq to a pole
 - The previous prophets also tied the Buraq
 - Nobody really knows where this location is but it is estimated now

The Journey of Miraaj

- The Prophet ﷺ knocking on each gate
 - Each level had a gatekeeper who would ask who this is
 - And when he entered, they were extremely happy but did not know why he was there
- Seeing Adam on the first level
 - In the first sky, he meets Adam who says "Welcome Oh righteous son"
 - Both Adam and Ibrahim call him their son
 - There were also two rivers by Adam. They were the Euphrates and the Nile. Two rivers on earth which are actually from the heavens (among mountains, Tur and Uhud)
 - The Prophet ﷺ asked lots of question, he was trying to soak it all in. Ex: all of the things he saw during the journey
 - And there was a cup made of pearls and rubies
 - The Prophet ﷺ asked Jibreel and he said it was the river of Kawthat
- Second level
 - The gatekeeper says welcome welcome
- Who did he meet in each sky? Anas says this is what I remember, implying that the order might be off

- 2: Idris
- 3: harun
- 4: doesn't remember
- 5: Musa, who said I never thought anyone could be raised above me
- Seeing Musa
 - In another narration he cried and said this man has taken the largest nation from me
 - However he also advises the Prophet ﷺ to lower the amount of salah we have to do
- Being taken to sidrat Al Muntaha
 - Sidrat means lotus tree
 - Muntaha means the highest point that can be reached
 - Jibreel could not go past this point
 - It has water around it
 - It is where the souls of the most pious are taken
- Ayat in Surah Tur
 - "The roof that is most elevated" is alluded to in the surah
 - Also alludes to river beneath the arsh of Allah in which the water is special
 - In it people do not drown
 - The righteous people are washed in this water when they die
 - And they have a moistness but they are not wet
 - Some salaf mentioned seeing people in their dreams
- Then the Prophet ﷺ negotiates the amount of salah
 - It started off with 50 salah per day
 - Musa keeps sending him back, says my people could not do 3
 - The Prophet ﷺ says I am too shy
 - The Prophet ﷺ also know what is better for his ummah
- Sidebar: Ghazali on why the Prophet ﷺ didn't just ask for 5 to begin with
 - 1: For the ummah to recognize how hard the Prophet ﷺ worked to lower it from 50 to 5 for us. The nidham (system) should've been 50
 - 2: The Prophet ﷺ did not want to leave Allah. He was using it as an excuse. It could also be that Allah wanted it. Corroborated with the fact that when he was dying he asked Jibreel, what does Allah want? And Jibreel answered that Allah is yearning to meet you
- Lesson: When Allah is your destination, even the halal is a distraction
 - The Prophet ﷺ did not take breaks or get distracted even though he was meeting the other prophets
 - When you are meeting Allah, it is not the time to get distracted
 - The Prophet ﷺ could have sat and talked to them, but his muntaha is Allah
 - Good reminder for us in Ramadan right now, engaging in sawm

Ar Razi's Differences of Opinion of How the Journey Took Place

- Body vs soul
 - The Prophet ﷺ was taken on the journey with his body
 - Or that he was taken on it with his soul
 - Between sleep and being awake when Jibreel came to him
- Small detail about the narrations
 - Everytime the Prophet ﷺ says "I saw" Abu Bakr says "sabaqta"
 - I testify that you are a siddique
- About prophets being able to travel the unseen
 - Suleiman could travel very fast
- In favor of the opinion of body and soul
 - The body travelling is what makes it a miracle
 - The soul and the body are connected, and the soul separating from the body would imply a form of death
- Cannot use the irrationality of miracles as a justification for not believing

The Prophet ﷺ Leading the Other Prophets in Prayer

- Returning and praying
 - Musa and Ibrahim in the front row
 - One of the two tell
 - Surah Ala and Surah Ghashia
 - Not from tawaatur
- Understanding the souls of prophets
 - Unclear how the prophets are both in heaven and in Jerusalem praying
 - However we do know that the Prophet ﷺ has his soul returned to him when people send salawat upon him, so that he can return it
 - The souls of prophets only travel to the extent that the Prophet ﷺ has told us about
- Connection of the soul to the body
 - The soul is always attached to the bodies
 - The bodies of prophets do not decay like everyone else
 - Everyone else, the pious' souls are elevated (given a nice scent, and a good place)
- The souls of shaheed
 - The way they receive salam is different
 - They are enjoying the heavens with their bodies (but not necessarily the state of their bodies in dunya)
 - Narrations that they are there now as birds

Ch 7: The Prophetic Fountain

Ch 7: The Prophetic Fountain

Date Covered: 2/24 @ 1325

The Fountain (al-hawd), with which Allah Almighty honored him as nourishment for his nation, is true.

- Al Ghiyath
 - Meaning missed
- Its location and how it looks
 - The hawd of kawthar
 - What is it
 - It is a continuation of the water under the arsh of Allah ﷻ
 - We have also heard that the water of Jannah is attached to the water under the arsh of Allah ﷻ
- The beauty of this hawd
 - We know it exist both inside and outside of Jannah
 - Hadith mentions that the water is “clear” like milk (referring to its purity)
 - Its cups are like pearls and they have names written on them
 - The water is sweet like honey
 - A person who drinks from it will not feel thirst anymore
 - It also heals all illness
 - Akin to zamzam, which fulfills whatever need a person intends of it
- How will we benefit from the hawd
 - When you’ve crossed through the stages and made it to the hashr
 - The fifth stage is the hawd
 - Analogy: You’ve won the game but your physically exhausted
 - The first relief you will be given on the DOJ is drinking from the hawd
- The Prophet ﷺ on the DOJ
 - Will be near the mizan, seen interceding
 - On the bridge, pushing people forward and making dua for them
 - In one hadith he says, I’ll be grabbing you by your collars
 - Some people will cross quickly while others will be crawling
 - In another narration he says he will see us on the hawd
 - “Meet me on the hawd” and “Look for me on the hawd” in different narrations
 - And the Prophet ﷺ will hand us our cup from his own hands
- The people who are pulled away
 - As the Prophet ﷺ is handing someone his cup, the angels will pull him away
 - The angels will say that he is left your sunnah
 - Even though this person has already made it past hisaab, why are they being pulled away

- The person may not be punished with Jahanam but the virtue of drinking from the Prophet ﷺ's hand is only for those who follow his sunnah
- Some people will even be helping the Prophet ﷺ pass out water
- What happens to the hawd after we enter jannah
 - A lot of commentators say that it wasn't only made for drinking
 - It was given specific traits for our ummah
 - No other prophet or ummah will be standing there
 - It will continue to be what it was before and it will be a body of water in jannah
 - Some say it will be a place of souls being washed
- Does anyone disregard the hawd?
 - Not in detail
 - The mutazzilites believe in its existence but nothing beyond that

Ch 8: The Intercession

Ch 8: The Intercession

Date Covered: 2/24 @ 1338

The Intercession (al-shafa'ah), which he deferred for them until the Day of Resurrection, is true as related in the narrations.

- What is shafaa?
 - Intercession. Someone having to stand up on your behalf
- Clarification: shafaa vs salvation in Christianity
 - Salvation only comes from Allah ﷻ
 - Some Asharis/salafis look at shafaa from a very distant view of it, and that ultimately only your deeds get you jannah
 - Some people started speaking about the Prophet ﷺ's shafaa as if it were salvation
 - This is not part of the muslim creed
 - People often misunderstand due to their lack of grasp on the Arabic language
- What are we allowed to ask the Prophet ﷺ for?
 - We can not ask him for forgiveness or salvation
 - But we can ask for shafaa
- Can shafaa be denied?
 - No. It appears in the Quran (ex: Ayat al Qursi, which Allah ﷻ alludes to allowing the Prophet ﷺ to have shafaa)
- The details of shafaa in hadith
 - Hadith: All of the people will run to Adam AS asking for him to ask Allah ﷻ for the DOJ to begin. Adam will respond, this is not my position. My mistake makes me fearful of Allah ﷻ, ask Nuh. Nuh will say the same thing, but that he asked Allah ﷻ a question that was unbefitting to ask. Then Ibrahim, then Isa. Then the Prophet ﷺ.
 - Analogy: The favorite sibling will speak to the parent when they are upset
- The unique trait to the Prophet ﷺ
 - Hadith: People asked, every prophet was given something unique, what were you given? He answered, shafaatul kubra
 - He will be the shafi on the DOJ
 - Maqam al Mahmud is referring to this position
 - The angels refer to him by this for that reason
 - Every prophet was given a dua, our Prophet ﷺ chose to save his for the DOJ
 - He had the option of using at Taif but chose not to
- How the Prophet ﷺ will give shafaa
 - He will deliver the best praises to Allah ﷻ to have been heard

- He says: I will praise Allah ﷻ in a way that no angel has and that has never been heard before. Then Allah ﷻ will tell me to raise my head, you have prayed enough. There was a time when people would plug their ears when you spoke, now speak
- Then 70,000 people will be allowed to enter jannah without hisaab
- Then the Prophet ﷺ will say, increase for me. And it will be his first time making such a request
- Then another 70k, and he asks for more
- Allah ﷻ will then permit for the Prophet ﷺ to do shafaa for all of his ummah, and anyone who has a mustard seeds worth of imaan, the Prophet ﷺ's shafaa will be accepted for them
- Acknowledging accountability while shafaa exists
 - There was a man who had a drinking problem, who kept asking for forgiveness
 - The Prophet ﷺ heard criticism and said, my shafaa is for the major sinners of my ummah
 - Poem: All of the ummah will stand, and the sinners will call, and they will say Who will save us today? In that time the Prophet ﷺ will come
- 3 means of entering Jannah
 - 1: Amal/our deeds. Your faraid have to be fulfilled and you have to have tawba for that which was missed
 - 2: Shafaat al Kubra, which everyone will benefit but not everyone will need
 - 3: Allah ﷻ's mercy. Ultimately this is enough for everyone, but in order to earn it you have to have deeds
- Jannah is ultimately from Allah ﷻ's mercy
 - Analogy: A student who worked really hard but still failed
 - Whoever makes an effort for the deed will earn the mercy of Allah ﷻ
 - The greatest moments of dua are right after periods of effort, or moments of action
- Side topic: Saying salam to the Prophet ﷺ
 - Sheikh Yusuf would cover his face when saying salam to the Prophet ﷺ, how can I show my face when it is sinful
- Side topic: the Prophet ﷺ's uniqueness
 - He was able to dispel the deep attachments to blood bonds without devaluing them
- Side topic: About Nuh
 - About Nuh: had asked, what about my son. Who did not accept islam. And Allah ﷻ responded to him in a very stern manner, he is not from your family he is a bad deed (regarding his shirk), never ask about something you have no knowledge of. Allah ﷻ then says I am advising you one last time before you become jahil/from the ignorant ones. Then Nuh responds immediately with

remorse, I will not ask and forgive me. The next two passage are then all about honoring him

- Allah ﷻ is the greatest murabbi
- Allah ﷻ corrects Nuh but then shows how he is honored
- Shafaa of normal people
 - The hafiz of 10 people (most authentic)
 - The alim of 70 people
 - The khadim of 100 people
 - The deceased child (before puberty) for their parents, whom the Prophet ﷺ said will be an investment for you
 - If your actions have weight, you have to ability to intercede as well
 - Particularly for minor sins
 - The Prophet ﷺ for major sins and other people for minor sins
- Side topic: The hafiz who has no amal and expects honor without applying what they've learned
-
- Side topic: Things which distort the purity of our deeds
 - Riya. Showing off
 - Speaking about our deeds after we've done them
 - Reminder: Don't need to
 - Ali RA said you people hide your sins the way we used to hide our good deeds
- Side topic: hidden sins
 - Pose a grave harm, like a cancer

Are there any conditions in which the Prophet ﷺ's shafaa is not accepted

Ch 9: Divine Providence

Ch 9: Divine Providence

Date Covered: Class missed 3/23, 3/24 @ 1300

Thus, take extreme caution from that type of investigation, thinking, and insinuation. For Allah Almighty has hidden the knowledge of providence from His creatures and has prohibited them from seeking it, as said by Allah Almighty in His Book, 'He will not be questioned about what He does, but they will be questioned.' 58 Whoever asks why He did something has rejected the judgment of the Book, and whoever rejects the judgment of the Book is among the unbelievers.59

- Tawa
 - Meaning to fold
- Anaam
 - Meaning all creation
- Manamihi
 - Meaning to seek out or shoot for
- The question of how and why has not been answered for anyone
 - Even when the Prophets were asked "how" they weren't given answers
 - The asking of "how" is not a relationship that we have with Allah ﷻ
 - Ex: Zakariya with his child, Maryam with her pregnancy
 - Prophets were taught even more so than us what tawakkul should be
- The one who asks "how" and "why" has gone against Allah ﷻ, but "if" is not off limits
 - They "why" is far more dangerous
 - Importance of programming ourselves to not asking why
 - Allah ﷻ also does not hold us accountable for things we say in moments of rage, difficulty, grief etc
 - If a person does do so, they should make tawbah
 - Even in his most challenging moments the Prophet ﷺ did not ask "why"
- People who are always questions the reason why will lose their trust in Allah ﷻ
 - Its like rejecting ayaat of the quran
 - Asking why can be like rejection
 - Analogy: the person in school getting graded, does not question the grading system
 - The nizam of Allah ﷻ is perfect
 - If we can program ourselves to not ask why in other places, why do we do so with Allah ﷻ?
- Importance of knowing Allah ﷻ
 - A person who does not know Allah ﷻ will always feel wronged by him
 - Similarly a person who has wandering eye will have a unfulfilled heart

- Root causes of asking why
 - Comparison
 - Ingratitude
 - Moments of weakness
- Side bar: Complaining
 - Sometimes people say Alhamdulillah as a way

This is the summary of what is needed by those who have enlightened hearts among the allies of Allah Almighty. It is the degree of those rooted in knowledge, for knowledge in the creation is of two types: accessible knowledge and inaccessible knowledge. To deny accessible knowledge is unbelief, and to claim to know what is inaccessible is unbelief. Faith is only affirmed by accepting accessible knowledge and abandoning pursuit of inaccessible knowledge.

- This is how the hearts of Allah's friends should be
 - They understand Allah ﷻ
 - And they are content with him
 - They do not complain
 - And they do not ask why
 - They do not get frustrated with him
- Being deeply rooted in knowledge
 - There is knowledge amongst the creation that we have access to and knowledge that we don't
 - When Musa was being taught by Khidr, one of the main points was that Khidr had access to things Musa did not, but that it did not give Musa the right to ask
- Ilmal la dunni vs ilmi wahabi vs kasabi
 - Dunni: Knowledge that is with someone
 - Wahabi: Vs knowledge that is gifted (ex: intuition)
 - Ilm kasabi:
 - Some say that wahabi can only be attained through exhausting yourself in ilm kasabi
- If a person denies the knowledge that we do have access to is kufr, and claiming to have knowledge of the unknown is also kufr
- ***TS 1327: Ones imaan cannot be firm without accepting knowledge and rejecting the inaccessible***
- Kabul ilm al mawjood
 - Meaning accepting knowledge that is confirmed
 - Not being in the habit of rejecting sound knowledge (which is the mistake of both the jews and the christians)

- Rejecting sound knowledge is a slippery slope which eventually leads to rejecting the Quran
- Side Bar: Upholding the Quran as Haqq
 - Umar RA, the woman who said will you deny our rights (regarding mehr) and brought an ayah of the quran
 - And in another incidence, him getting enraged at a man accusing him of denying his rights
 - Narration, I stood up and I blocked my uncle and said to Umar, hold onto pardoning people, and command people with goodness, and turn away from people with ignorance.
 - Each time he said it, Umar RA calmed down
 - A person's faith can never be stable unless a person accepts all of quran and hadith into their heart
 - We will not always be in spaces that are filled with angels
 - Even very knowledgeable people commit suicide, because nobody knows their trajectory
- A person cannot be safe in their faith without abandoning that which is unknown

Ch 10: The Preserved Tablet and the Pen

Ch 10: The Preserved Tablet and the Pen

Date Covered: 3/24 @ 1342, 3/25 @ 1335

We believe in the Preserved Tablet (al-lawh al-mahfuz), the Pen, and in everything inscribed on it.

- Luh al Mahfuz
 - The place where all of knowledge is preserved
 - Analogy: Like a hard drive with all of the information
- Why does Allah ﷻ need a preserved tablet?
 - The greatest companies have 5 year, 10 year, etc plans
- Qalam
 - Is the qalam an actual pen?
 - We say yes, it is a real pen that Allah ﷻ created
 - The pen is the thing that is scribing
 - Mutazzilites say it doesn't exist
 - But the ayah, "the pen and that which it writes" implies that there is a real pen
 - It is among the first creations of Allah ﷻ
- Side topic: The purpose of the unseen/ghayb
 - Believing in things without it feeling believable
 - Analogy: Twins in a mothers womb. One baby talks about a world outside, while the other thinks they'll be in the womb forever. Won't be convinced until they actually see it
 - If we knew how amazing akhirah is, we wouldn't want to live in this world
 - Allah ﷻ's veil over the unseen is for our protection
 - Allah ﷻ has limited our scope of reasoning, has given us the ability to make mistakes/nisyan, so that we can actually enjoy dunya
- Hadith: 7 heavens, and then 70,000 veils between ? and ?

If all creation gathered against something Allah Almighty had decreed to be, that they try to make it not exist, they would have no power to do so. If all of them gathered against something Allah had not decreed to be, that they try to bring it into existence, they would have no power to do so. The Pen has dried of what will be until the Day of Resurrection.

- Independent read

Whatever a person has missed, he would have never received. Whatever he received, he would have never missed.

- Hadith of the Prophet ﷺ's promise to Ali
 - Context of him having to face the khawarij, who came from his own army and eventually killed him
 - Ibn Abbas came to Ali one day and asked him, how are you still able to lead despite these attacks?
 - He responded that the Prophet ﷺ told him he would wear a cloak, and people would try to tug on it but that he should never let it go
 - Ibn Abbas never cried until he heard this
- Even if things get in the way, what Allah جل جلاله has written for you will not miss you

Side Bar: Khalifa History

- Lesson: even the greatest people make mistakes, but that doesn't mean they should leave their positions
 - Ex: Muawiyya giving khalifa to his son and showing him how to fight off others. Told him not to worry about Abdullah ibn Umar, ibn Abbas. Fight ibn Zubair. Don't go near Hassan.
 - Side fact: Hassan was poisoned by his spouse, who was bought out
- Side story: Ali's death
 - Ali was killed by the Khawarij. They planned to kill Ali, Ibn Zubair, and Muawiyya on the same day
 - Ali would walk the city at night without his sword to show that the city was safe, and they attacked him while he was going for fajr. They threw a rock at his head, and the guy who killed Ali asked for his tongue not to be cut off because he wanted to do dhikr
- Side topic: Yazid
 - Second Umayyid khalifa, who Hassan didn't pledge to
 - One of the first to express regret over Hassan
 - Knew what people were doing but not to the extent
 - Hassan's wife went to him and asked for money

The servant must know that the knowledge of Allah of all that exists in His creation has already preceded. He measured all of that with precise measurement, judgment, and finality. There is nothing to reduce it, nor amend it, nor remove it, nor change it, nor divert it, nor decrease it, nor add to it.

- Wahkaman
 - Meaning with judgment
- Wadhaman
 - Meaning finalized
- Yuzidu

- Meaning remove
- Tahweel
 - Meaning to divert
- Naqis
 - To reduce

All of that is among the beliefs of faith, the fundamentals of gnosis, and the recognition of the oneness of Allah Almighty and His Lordship, as the Almighty said in His book, 'He created all things and measured them with precise measurement,' And the Almighty said, 'The command of Allah is a decisive decree,' Then woe to him whose heart becomes ill regarding providence. He has traversed the path of his delusions in investigating the Unseen, its secrets and hidden aspects. He ends up as a sinful liar due to what he said.

- Aqd
 - Knotted
- Aqeedah is a matter that need to be firmly knotted
 - People are most tested in times of difficulty
 - A persons base is their recognition of Allah ﷻ and his control over all things
 - It's a heavy realization for someone who is disappointed with their circumstances
- The condition of a belief is not acceptance however, but pleasure
 - Qubul is not a sign of imaan
 - But pleasure with is
 - Our feebleness, our faqeer in front of Allah is what makes us content
- Be cautious of endlessly asking whys. Allah ﷻ has already set us up to succeed in both dunya and akhira

Marifa of Allah ﷻ

- Assignment: 5 min conversation about the greatness of Allah ﷻ
 - The majority of the Quran is Allah ﷻ's ta'deem
 - The early sahaba just had their imaan as a topic of conversation
 - The tawheed of Allah ﷻ is enough to keep us occupied in speech
 - Why is iqrar of la ilaha illallah so important? So that we can absorb it into our heart
- You will rarely find a person who talks about Allah ﷻ, glorifies him, and appreciates him to leave that state in times of difficulty
 - Even in their complaints they will have ridaa/contentment

Ch 11: Arsh and Kursi

Ch 11: Arsh and Kursi

Date Covered: 3/26 @ 1310, 3/30 @ 1312

3 discussions. What is it, where is it, and the istiwa/uluwiyaa.

- The normal person might not even know this is a conversation to be had
 - It is mostly relevant to the classroom
 - Questions about it mostly come from children and bedouins
 - This is not necessarily an essential conversation
 - Sometimes given unnecessary importance outside of ilm
 - But is important to aqeedah

What is It

- There are various opinions, which are not accepted
 - For example, the opinion of Imam Dhahabi (is Athari)
 - Has a 1000 page book on just the arsh
 - Jahmiyas, who say its not an actual throne but just a concept. They believe that theres not tajsim (giving allah ﷻ parts) at any level. In their belief, Allah ﷻ is not in the creation and not on the arsh because a body is needed to sit on a throne
- Generic ahlul sunnah opinion of arsh
 - Is that the arsh is like a throne
 - Hadith: The arsh is carried, and the distance of from one ear to the other ear of the angel is 700 years
- Kursi
 - Is the stage, not a chair on the throne
 - It is also one of the first of Allah ﷻ's creations
- Arsh
 - In arabic it actually means roof
 - It plays the role of being a roof over the entirety of the universe, but is the actual roof of jannah
- The arsh's beauty
 - Described in hadith

Where is It

- Interesting opinions
 - Fair to share, not necessarily true

- Hadith: Someone asked, where was Allah ﷻ before ? and where does the arsh of Allah ﷻ sit. On water. What does the water sit on? It is floating/suspended water
- Some say that Allah ﷻ's arsh is also Bayt Al Mamour
- One time a man was struck in the face because he took an oath by Musa being the best of Allah ﷻ's creation
 - The Prophet ﷺ said don't argue about the prophets
 - Then the Prophet ﷺ I will be the first raised but I will look up and see Musa holding onto the arsh of Allah ﷻ already
- Is arsh a siffa or a creation?
 - A creation
- Hadith say the arsh of Allah ﷻ is held up by angels
 - How to corroborate with it being on water?
 - Its both
 - OR to give timeline, it was on water until Allah ﷻ created angels
- Significance/symbolism
 - Kings who have come since, have always tried to have water under their thrones
 - It is consistent with the human nature of understanding power
- Some scholars saw the arsh to be
 - Ar Razi, Ibn Sina (mostly known to be a philosopher)
 - Can consider this view the aristotle view of the arsh
 - Ar Razi would call the arsh the 9th sky
 - Almost like a dimension
 - Rooted in greek philosophy so it doesn't have much basis, though it comes from people we respect
 - Ar Razi however is very respected by Asharis, so sometimes his opinion is spoken about like it is mainstream
 - Wasiya kursi: They take the literal meaning of wasiya
- Denying the arsh is like denying a tawatur claim
 - Imam Malik was once asked about it
 - He became very red and upset, and said take this man out of my gathering
 - The guy was a jahimiya, was definitely instigating
 - We do not discuss the how, we just acknowledge that it is
- Rivers coming from the arsh lead to jannah and fuel the awd al kawthar

Istiwa al Arsh

- The first claim: of the Hanbalis (Athari)
 - A person can be different madhabs by fiqh and creed
 - Ex: most Shafis are ashari by creed

- The athari claim is that Allah ﷻ has a physical dominance on his arsh and therefore a position
- Hadith: A child came and asked, where is Allah ﷻ, and he responded 'above'
- What part do the asharis disagree with? Allah ﷻ cannot be confined to a position. Him having an arsh does not necessitate that he cannot be somewhere else
- Scholar who said when a lay person ask where Allah ﷻ is, we say above
- However we should not be limiting the position of Allah ﷻ
- Second claims: of the Ashari
 - Allah ﷻ takes whatever position he wishes
 - Allah ﷻ is above the arsh but not limited to it
 - Similarly his traits manifest without him being in a place, so if he is in a place he still exists everywhere
 - Proven by discussions about Allah ﷻ's qurb and decension to the lowest skies on specific occasions
- Athari arguments/rebuttals
 - The atharis explain this by saying thats specifically related to Allah ﷻ's mercy
 - And their rebuttal is that it implies tajalli (like what the Christians say, in regards to Allah ﷻ appearing in human form)
- What it means for Allah ﷻ to be qarib
 - Allah ﷻ can be far at times
 - Allah ﷻ is not necessarily everywhere at all times, but his is not limited in his movement
 - Rather his siffat are sufficient for him to fulfill things
 - Like how someone says "I see allah ﷻ in the trees", you're not actually seeing Allah ﷻ, but rather his qudra
 - Allah ﷻ is not in the tree but his qudra and the displays of his siffat are
 - 2 opinions: anywhere, everywhere, at the same time OR he doesn't need to be everywhere because his siffat are sufficient
- The only people deny istiwa are the mutazzilites
 - Though we cannot fully comment on Allah ﷻ's position
 - It is firm that no muslim can deny the possibilities of Allah ﷻ

FROM THE BOOK

The Throne (al-'arsh) and the Footstool (al-kursī) are true.

He is independent of the Throne and whatever is beneath it.

He encompasses all things and He is above it, and what He has created is incapable of encompassing Him.⁷¹

Ch 12: Ibrahim as a Khalil of Allah

Ch 12: Ibrahim as a Khalil of Allah

Date Covered: 3/30 @ 1314

We say that Allah has taken Abraham, upon him be peace, as an intimate friend⁷² and that He spoke directly to Moses, faithfully, truthfully, and in surrender to Allah.

- We as ahlul sunnah do not deny any of the qualities of the other prophets which are mentioned in the Quran
 - This is unlike the other peoples
 - Some discussions in the other creeds of islam dont consider Musa AS speaking to Allah ﷻ to be a creed issue
- Khalil
 - Meaning your only friend
 - One for whom your heart is empty of any other love for anyone else
- Regarding people who do not accept the miracles of the Quran
 - Isa AS touching someone and removing their leprosy for example
 - We are not in any position to say it wasn't instantaneous, we accept that this was a power given to Allah ﷻ
- Other prophets: Isa AS
 - There are many opinions on his power of bringing people back to life and how it was done
- Words for friendship
 - The word khalil is the highest in the linguistic sense
 - With respects to the Prophet ﷺ, habib is the highest
 - Habib is the one who is also desired
 - The tier for a believer is siddique

Ch 13: Belief in Angels, Prophets, Books

Ch 13: Belief in Angels, Prophets, Books

Date Covered: 3/30 @ 1321

We have faith in the angels, the Prophets, and the Books revealed to the Messengers. We testify that they were all upon the clear truth.

- Belief in angels
 - That they are sinless and have no propensity to sin
 - That they are indefinitely obedient
 - That they do not seek personal fulfillment
 - They do not have needs like eating and drinking
 - They seek fulfillment strictly through ibadah (though this is also the case in humans)
- Incorrect beliefs on angels
 - The jews accepted the prophets and books but not jibreel
 - The Christians believing that angels are the daughters of god
 - Mutazilites not acknowledging other angels outside of the ones mentioned by name in the Quran
- Belief in the Prophets
 - We believe in the existence of other prophets
 - We do not feel the need to affirm the prophethood of other people outside of the ones mentioned in the Quran
 - Some scholars even consider it lahu to talk about other prophets which are not mentioned
- We don't follow the sunnah of any other prophet ﷺ, but we do have to believe in their prophethood and give them the appropriate respect
 - The sin of disrespecting any prophet is the same doing so to the Prophet ﷺ
 - But that doesn't mean that we follow them
 - Story: MAW went for umrah and asked why the men run and the women don't. His answer was that we do not follow the sunnah of Hajar but of the Prophet
- Belief in the previous books
 - We don't follow either of the previous books because they are unpreserved
 - But we do not reject that they were the truth when they came down to humanity or that their prophets received them
 - When Musa came, he came with separate texts
 - Musa AS also had the concept of abrogation
- Side story
 - The Prophet ﷺ saw Umar reading a torah, and he turned red, the Prophet ﷺ said do not, read the quran instead

- In our time its different, people study it for the sake of navigating conversations, not for the purpose of affirming the truth
- The quran is the truth, we do not need the other texts to prove the quran right.

3/31 @ 1308

- The angels leave the salah when the rows are not straight, and thats one of the reasons why shaytan enters
- Similarly a believer speaks up while being oppressed, the angels leave. And it is specifically because the believers brothers should have been defending him

Ch 14: A Muslim Prays towards Mecca

Ch 14: A Muslim Prays towards Mecca

Date Covered: 3/30 @ 1336, 3/31 @ 1317

We name the people who pray towards Mecca (ahl al-qiblah) as 'Muslims' and 'believers' as long as they remain upon what was brought by the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, recognizing and confirming as true everything he said and reported.

- Praying towards the kibla is enough for us to affirm belief and eating from halal is muslim
 - This is from hadith
 - There is not hate mongering happening in our classrooms
 - And there is no denying other people for the sake of uplifting our truth
 - A person might not be necessarily ahlul sunnah but they are still muslim if they meet these requisites
- The benefit of having such a broad definition
 - We do not get to decide who is muslim
 - It is a form of protection from internal dissension (ex: the khawarij causing violence through their accusations)
 - Allows people to recover from their mistakes (ex: the ones who made tawbah after believing in the false prophets after the Prophet ﷺ)
- Side topic: praying janazah on the one who committed suicide
 - Opinions: they were mukallah (not liable)/ marfoo al qalam
 - The khalifa/imam cannot lead their janazah because it is a major sin
 - TS 1346
- Story from Seerah of denying someones islam
 - Usama ibn Zaid killed someone after he killed someone who said kalima
 - The Prophet ﷺ was very upset with him
 - Usama was embarrassed by how upset the Prophet ﷺ was
- Side facts about Usama
 - One time Abdullah ibn Umar asked his father why Usama gets more money than him, and he responded that the Prophet ﷺ loved Usama more
- Affirming the truth of what the prophet ﷺ says
 - Whoever throws the word kufr upon another Allah جلّ throws it upon them
- Ranks in virtues vs disbelief
 - It okay to attribute virtue
 - It is not okay to attribute disbelief

We do not speak vainly about Allah, nor do we argue about the religion of Allah.

- Creed is not something for us to be arguing over in public, especially with other muslims

We do not dispute the Quran. We testify that it is the speech of the Lord of the worlds, sent down by the Trustworthy Spirit (Angel Gabriel), who taught it to the master of the Messengers, Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him. It is the speech of Allah Almighty, in no way equal to the speech of creatures. We do not claim it is His creation, nor do we oppose the united community of Muslims.

- Quran is kalaam Allah ﷻ not khalq Allah ﷻ
 - Already spoken about
- It was taught to us the Prophet ﷺ
 - We similarly affirm the teaching of the sahaba and the tabieen
- Side topic: the words used in association with the Prophet ﷺ
 - Sayyidina, mawla etc.

We do not excommunicate anyone who prays toward Mecca due to a sin, as long as he does not claim it to be lawful, nor do we say sins do not harm the faith of those who commit them.

- Istihlal
 - Making something haram into halal
 - Specifically in regards to things which are mutwaatir
 - The moment someone does istihlaal over such a matter they are not muslim
 - Ex: alcohol, eating pig, prayer, homosexuality, murder etc.
- A person is liable for what they know, and liable for pursuing knowledge of what they do not know
 - If a person unknowingly believes something is impermissible, that considered khata/a mistake, not kufr
 - However if they fail to search for what is permissible that is ghaflah/negligence and they are sinful for that too
- A person is kufr for denying a mutawaatir sin but they are not kufr for failing to recognize the mutawaatir sin
 - For example, a person recognizing that music is haram, but not considering a specific song as music
 - Or recognizing that hijab is obligatory but having a different opinion of what hijab is
- Regarding the people who say that sins don't harm your imaan
 - The people who take this opinion are known as the Jabaria, who think that imaan is a constant
 - We do not believe in this

We hope that Allah will pardon the good-doers among the believers and admit them into Paradise by His mercy. We cannot guarantee it for them and we cannot testify that they will be in Paradise. We seek forgiveness for the sinful, we fear for them, yet we do not despair over them.

- Do not think of them as sinner but as people who believe in Allah ﷻ and will receive his mercy
 - However in the tafsir of the ayah of people committing zina, which states that Allah ﷻ removes imaan from their hearts, we can consider the possibility that a person is not muslim while they are sinning
 - Hadith: Allah ﷻ forgives people for one good deed in their entire life
- We do not testify complete aman (safety) for anyone
 - We believe in only that which Allah ﷻ says
 - Nothing else regarding a person outcome is guaranteed
 - Ex: signs of a good/bad death
- Seeking forgiveness for the sinful and fearing for them, while not despairing
 - Hasan al Basri said, hope and fear are like two wings of a bird
 - A believer should always be between hope and hopelessness
- We all have safety because we are muslims but we have iyaas because of our sins
 - This includes anyone who prays towards the kaaba

Ch 15: Faith is Words and Actions

Ch 15: Faith is Words and Actions

Date Covered: 4/1 @ 1313

Faith consists of affirmation by the tongue and acceptance by the soul.

- Iqrar
 - With the tongue
 - The person who does not do iqrar, an example is Abu Talib and the Jews of Madina
 - Hence why reading the shahada is a condition of being muslim
- Tasdeeq
 - With the soul
 - The person who does not have tasdeeq is a munafiq
 - Hence why, when converting people, you start with building the foundations of their belief in tawheed
- Once a person has understood tawheed, asking them to say the words is not that hard
 - Dawah to ahlul kitab can be easier because they already understand the concept of tawheed and nabuwa
 - Books of fiqh explain that before a shahada takes place, a person has to negate what they believed in before
- Story
 - Shahada in Ramadan at MII, done by Mufti Aasim
 - Mufti Aasim interrogated him a little bit and he had to say yes 15 times before they moved onto the kalima
- Other opinions
 - Some say that whoever has done iqrar is muslim, despite them not necessarily having tasdeeq
 - Asharis say tasdeeq is the only condition for being muslim
 - ? says you will not see iqrar and tasdeeq without amal. Thus in order for a person to be considered muslim, they have to have amal bil jawali
 - However, saying it with the tongue is an amal
- Sometimes there's people who say take shahada without even realizing what it really means. Is that something that works in their favor?
 - Since they've done iqrar but not tasdeeq
 - When I'm saying shahada I know to an extent what it means
 - It's not really a thing for someone to not actually know what they are saying
- Story
 - MAW was on a plane with an older white couple, ended up downloading english translation to her phone
 - Don't be shy to give dawah, with protection

- Dawah is just informing people, not an argument
- It needs to be done with wisdom because it can bring hostility
- How do you assess tasdeeq?
 - Ustadh Ubaidallah Evans says one of his first times buying into islam further was while talking to Jeremiah, Michael Jackson's brother.
 - And a janazah was led for him
 - Architect named Fazlur Rahman Khan was going to be buried in Baqi but his non muslim wife said he's not muslim and he ended up being buried in DC
- Iqrar is necessary but a witness is not
 - A person can hide their faith their entire life
 - Don't necessarily have to say it in public
 - Can just be saying it in private
 - Family, coworkers etc. don't need to know for it to constitute as imaan

All of what is authentic from the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, of the Law and clear teachings are true.

- As muslims we have to accept that which is authentic

Faith is one and its people are equal by default. The virtue of some over others is due to the fear of Allah, righteousness, opposing lowly desires, and adherence to the most important matters.

- Iman and amal is one jins
 - Anywhere you find a believer, by default, your imaan is equal
 - However your virtue/fadl is subject to change
 - Amal is also subject to change
- Khashiya
 - Fear of Allah ﷻ. A person who has this also has taqwa and wara, and the ability to prohibit their nafs from their desires. They are able to protect themselves from hawa
 - Hawa. Meaning wind. Used to refer to the stars
- Taqwa
 - Related hadiths
 - One time the Prophet ﷺ was talking about hisaab on the DOJ, and Umar asked if he would have his heart and body with him
 - Your initial response has to be your actual reality
 - The Prophet ﷺ was asked who would be doing their hisaab. When the Prophet ﷺ answered Allah ﷻ, the person said I'm not worried

- Umar on the other hand. Wanted to check if he is on the list of munafiq. What type of fear and taqwa must you cultivate to still be wondering if you are on the right list?
- Fadl
 - Virtue is in taking the opinions which are most preferred
 - Mulazima: Meaning to latch onto
 - The base is imaan but your duty is to latch onto that which is the preferred opinion
 - Ex: not listening even to the permissible nasheeds
 - The high achieving believer is one who strives for wara
- The noblest are the ones who have itaa
 - Meaning obedience
 - These people are also careful in follow the matters of the Quran

Ch 16: Those who Commit Major Sins

Ch 16: Ahlul Kabair/ Those who Commit Major Sins

Date Covered: 4/2 @ 1317, 4/6 @ 1305, 4/7 @ 1310

Those who commit major sins among the nation of Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him, may be in Hellfire but will not reside there forever, if they die while they are monotheists, even if they have not repented. After they meet Allah knowing faith, they are subject to His will and His judgment. If He wills, He will forgive them and pardon them by His grace, as mentioned by the Almighty in His book, 'He forgives whatever is less than idolatry for whomever He wills.'

- A person can be deserving of jahannam if they commit major sins
 - The requirement upon that person is tawbah to avoid jahannam
 - The person who commits minor sins does not necessarily have to make tawbah
- We don't believe that jahannam is only for the kuffar
 - We don't believe that all a person need is imaan to avoid jahannam
 - Why would the Prophet ﷺ seek protection from jahannam?
 - It was a worry of tahleem (for the community)
 - A muslim, even in tawaf, is seeking protection from jahannam
 - There are various reasons why a muslim could be deserving jahannam, including dhalim against Allah ﷻ and the self
- A major sinner can be excused because of shafaa
 - The hadith that give the most hope is that of the Prophet ﷺ describing his shafaa
- Side topic: Hadd punishments
 - One of the purposes of hudud is to affirm the tawbah of a person
 - Most hudud also are only for those sins which have an impact on a society
 - Ex: interest vs theft
 - Hadd "completes" the tawbah for major sins and ensures that a person is not punished for it in the akhira
 - However there were minimal occasions where the hadd punishment was sought to be enforced. The few times it happened it was because the person confessed to it
- The Prophet ﷺ said no person will be punished twice
 - There was a woman who claimed her child was one of zina. I want to be forgiven.
 - Her blood landed on the clothes of someone and he reacted to it
 - The Prophet ﷺ responded "If her tawbah was taken and distributed across all the people of Madina, nobody would need to be forgiven"
 - There is no punishment for the person who sincerely repents

- Example, maliki opinion that missing 5 years of salah could be made up through tawbah
- Tawbah is the ultimate resolution for major sins
- Related: Two types of people
 - One who argues with the angels
 - One runs back into jahannam. I never obeyed your command, and this was my last chance to obey you so I did
 - Another one just stands there
 - Oh Allah ﷻ I have heard about your generosity and I did not think it would be possible for someone of your nature to take me out of jahannam and send me out
 - Both will be the last to be given jannah
- Whoever has even a small iota of imaan will not be there forever
- Various points
 - Masha vs lamas
 - Masha is a light touch
 - Lamas is a firm touch
 - Two words for cool breeze: lafha and nafha
 - Jahannam is allowed once, regularly to exhale
 - Hence why we don't pray at the time of zawal
 - Jahannam also has the ability to inhale, which is when we feel zamharir, the cold of jahannam
- Lesson: There should be no mentality in us that because we won't be in jahannam forever we shouldn't strive to avoid it
 - Even the inhalations and exhalations of jahannam are something for us to be afraid of
 - A small child, how do I know Allah ﷻ won't send the small kids first when my mom puts the small branches first. Imam Malik, says I never had tadabbur greater than what this child told me.
- Allah ﷻ can choose to forgive altogether and nobody would be able to ask why
 - Its like an outsider asking why a parent made a decision for their child
 - Even shirk, the ayah about shirk not being forgiven is specifically in the context of not making tawbah

Side topic: Balancing qualities

- Every quality, even negative ones, have an extent of positive impact
 - Imam Razi has an interesting take that every negative quality can be a positive one
- Hilm
 - Balancing awwa and halim

- Hilm is forbearance and patience
- Most people who have one do not have the other
- Hilm is not for what is haram, you have to correct things where it is necessary
- And if a person is doing something that is not haram but that needs to be fixed, often times you just need to make dua
- Awwa
 - A person that takes stress about the work that they are doing
 - Awwa is a very positive quality
 - This person only loses a breath out of inconvenience for you because they care
 - Like a mother stressed about their child
 - There is an extent where you might be worried about someone but you don't have to tell them or be stressed about it, make dua for them
 - If something doesn't have goodness, you can turn to Allah ﷻ and allow him to stop it or continue it
 - "If theres goodness in it may allah ﷻ grow it, and if there is not may allah ﷻ replace it with something better"
- Are there conditions in which awwa leads to anxiety? Are there other negative consequences besides a lack of hilm?
 - Interestingly the concept of tawakkul appears the most in Surah Talaq
 - Don't strangle your camel, just tie it
- Nisyan
 - Meaning forgetfulness
 - s necessary for a person to be able to enjoy life
- Ajla
 - Meaning haste
 - Haste. Can be bad but can also be good for a person, because people need urgency to get things done
- Hala
 - Meaning anxiety
 - Necessary to have an extent of anxiety to take care of yourself
- The Prophet ﷺ as a leader + his hilm
 - Some of the Badri sahabas walked in and the Prophet ﷺ made ishara for them to come, but the people sitting didn't move. And he was so hurt by it that he didn't say it again.
 - A leader also has haya. They will stay quiet
 - Another day a sahabi saw the Prophet ﷺ looking at him weird and then he shaved his head and came back. He felt the Prophet ﷺ's glance was one of

disapproval. Then the Prophet ﷺ smiled and said I didn't look at you for that reason, but this is better.

- As a teacher, he would not correct people, but would let them figure it out on their own.
- Another time there was a sahabi who had a red cloak, and got a look, and burnt it. The Prophet ﷺ said it would have been better to give it to the women or children
- On a different occasion someone was building a structure. Sahaba responded, "It's an Ansari". Then they rushed to him and let him know, and the guy levelled the structure and continued living on. He said about him, what a beautiful person
- Commentary mentions that the structure had obstructed the pathway, or that it had church like symbols
- Story
 - MAWs madrasa didn't like people standing out more than necessary
 - They didn't like clothes with cuffs on them, or nice collars
 - He and Sh. Abdul Aziz went and got simple clothes. Their teacher saw it and said now you look like a student of knowledge
- Moral: You have to have the ability to care without it paralyzing you

If He wills, He will punish them in Hellfire by His justice. Thereafter, He will bring them out of Hellfire by His mercy and the intercession of intercessors among those obedient to Him, then raise them to Paradise. This is because Allah Almighty is the ally of those who recognize Him and He will not deal with them in the two abodes as if they were the people who rejected Him, who failed to follow His guidance and did not earn His guardianship. O Allah, Guardian of Islam and its people, keep us firmly upon Islam until we meet You

- Whoever Allah ﷻ is pleased with, Allah ﷻ will allow to do shafaa
 - This is not limited to huffadh, who may choose 10 people
 - This can include sincere people
- Allah ﷻ's punishment is his adl
 - There are many ways to understand and explain it
 - How is it that non-muslims will be punished in jahannam forever, while there are muslims who have kalima but are terrible people and will be free from jahannam eventually
- Allah never misplaces his blessings
 - The same could be asked why did Allah ﷻ give me hidaya and not someone else
 - But all things are through Allah ﷻ's wisdom

- Allah ﷻ is just with delivering his punishments
 - A person is not accountable for what they are not aware of
 - But they are responsible for what they did not try to learn
- Allah ﷻ's judgement is not misplaced
 - Its possible that someone gets a job because their employer doesn't know the full picture
 - Allah ﷻ on the other hand combines his knowledge and wisdom
 - Hilm is being kind despite knowing full well how you were wronged
 - Allah ﷻ is Halim
 - Everything is balanced in his courts
- Who really decides what is just?
 - Just because you carry the mantle of justice in one place and one era does not mean that it is just
 - Allah ﷻ sending people to jahannam
- Allah ﷻ's forgiveness is so unique in that it forgives previous records
 - Unlike dunya standards of justice
 - How is it adil that people are serving 20 years for weed when its being sold at corner stores now?
 - Nothing that is haram today will become halal tomorrow and vice verse
 - The law of Allah ﷻ will never change
 - The variations in how people can be punished in this dunya are revealing of how injustice actually looks
- Allah ﷻ loves them more than we love them
 - Regarding the ones who are written for jahannam
- Discomfort with the prospect of eternal jahannam should lead us to fkr
 - If someone comes and says its not fair, ask them what are you doing about it? They're going there because you're not putting in any effort
 - Give them dawah, be a reason for them be safe from the fire of jahannam
 - You haven't reached a point of fkr, concern for others akhirah, until you are worried about every non muslim you meet
 - This was the concern of the Prophet ﷺ
- Its very possible that people have hidaya but lose it, or that they have it but they have no amal

We perform prayer behind every Imam who prays towards Mecca, whether righteous or wicked, as well as the funeral prayer over those who have died.

- It is not preferred but it is acceptable to pray behind anyone who is muslim
 - It is permissible
 - However there's people who go to Madina and refuse to pray behind them because they don't agree with their theology

- There were sahabi who even led salah drunk
 - Anas ibn Malik prayed behind him
 - He responded, regardless of who is leading you pray behind him
 - But since he was drunk, after he leaves, we will pray again

We do not declare any of them to be in Paradise or Hellfire. We do not accuse them of unbelief, nor idolatry. The people who pray towards Mecca are not excommunicated, nor accused of hypocrisy, as long as they have not openly demonstrated anything of that. We leave their inner secrets to Allah ﷻ Almighty.

- We leave their inner secrets to Allah ﷻ
 - Unless we have been shown that they are kaafr, we leave it to benefit of doubt
 - Not good to be complete passivists either, need to recognize the signs where they are

We do not raise the sword against anyone from the nation of Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him, except against those whom it is necessary to fight [such as violent rebels and criminals].

- In no aqeedah within islam is there allowance of dhulm
- Justice as islam defines it is enough for us
- We do not take any fellow muslims as enemies

We do not rebel against our leaders or those in charge of our affairs, even if they are tyrannical. We do not supplicate against them, nor withdraw from obedience to them. We view obedience to them as obedience to Allah ﷻ Almighty, an obligation, as long as they do not order disobedience to Allah. We supplicate on their behalf for righteousness and wellness.

- Specifically referring to the khalifa
 - If the process of appointing a khalifa was correct
 - Then we follow them
 - Only if we are being put on the path of sin do we argue against them
- However this theology feels different because we don't have any appropriately chosen leaders
 - Not necessarily realistic for us to follow our leaders
 - If we did have such a leader we would have to follow them regardless of their ijtihaad

We follow the Sunnah and the majority community, committed to the Sunnah and the majority community. We avoid anomalous opinions, differences, and sectarianism.

- Follow the jama'a
 - The ummah will never agree upon misguidance
 - This minority opinions can always be wrong
 - Especially in aqeedah
- The jama'a referring to the jama'a of the sahaba
 - Ex: the collective opinion of the sahaba that the Prophet ﷺ's body left for Israa wal Miraj
- The weight of the jama'a in the present day
 - Islam allows ijtihadd but it also recognizes the collective opinion of the people
- Iltizam
 - From lazim which means to make incumbent
 - One must have iltizam upon matters of the jama'a
 - Hold upon it with your canines, latch upon the sunnah
- Shadda
 - Meaning one-offs, anomalous
 - We will avoid such matters, unless there is a need for it
 - Ex: abortion
 - We will not be like Bani Israel and discuss matters which have no benefit
- Even in fiqh we should be careful in following one off opinions
 - Analogy: FDA approved medicine vs some random medicine a shady doctor gives you
 - We don't want to be "different"
 - You go to the expert, the common opinion
- Most shadda/one off opinions have already been explored by scholars in the past
 - If the opinion has been built on we can take it with confidence
 - Whereas if the opinion was rejected and debated by other scholars then it is better to leave off
 - Often times these opinions are not beneficial just interesting
 - The primary references of any discipline will tell you if an opinion is a shaad opinion
 - However in fiqh, knowing the shaad opinion is a pro not a con because it allows you to hold your ground
 - In aqeedah its a little different because it can lead you to darker places
- Khilaf
 - Meaning to create dissension, to provoke
 - We should avoid doing such a thing

- Furka
 - Meaning to break apart, to sect off
 - The Prophet ﷺ warned us against doing so

We love the people of justice and trustworthiness, for love of the people of justice is among the perfection of faith. We hate the people of injustice and treachery.

- Ahlul adil and ahlul amanah
 - Mostly referring to the sahaba
 - It is part of our creed to love justice and those who are trustworthy
- Ex: Umar ibn Abdul Aziz
 - Would not use a work lamp for personal things
 - Had a personal use lamp
- Having wara in matters of adil and amanah
 - These are two things which are essential to excel at
 - Especially in positions of leadership
- Juur and khiyana
 - Meaning injustice and oppression
 - It is part of our creed to dislike people who are unjust
 - Regardless of if it is coming from a muslim or a non muslim
- Ex: Umar RA would choose leaders based on how trustworthy they were
 - Ghazali talks about it, list 13-14 of them
 - Umar was very close to Muadh and Abu Obeida. Once evaluated how they handled shares
 - Abu Obeida: he distributed it, his wife asked why. Ended up giving his wife some shares
 - Muadh: also distributed and gave to his family
 - Both distributed their wealth before maghrib
 - Umar said they are exactly the same, two brothers from the same mother
 - Umar once said he was comfortable giving khilafa to either of them

Ch 17: Mashah of Socks

Mashah of Socks

Date Covered: 4/7 @ 1356

We say, 'Allah knows best,' regarding matters the knowledge of which is unclear to us.

- A matter of theology because it require accepting tawaatur
 - It is an amal which is built upon a creedal issue

We accept wiping over leather socks in ablution, for the traveler and the resident, as has come in the narrations.

- The belief in tawatur is a part of our creed
 - Imam Abu Hanifa says about it that came clear to him like the morning sun
 - This is one of the only tawaatur hadiths that also brings a hukum/ruling

Ch 18: Hajj and Jihad Until the DOJ

Hajj and Jihad Until the DOJ

Date Covered: 4/8 @ 1335, 4/8 @ 1334

Hajj pilgrimage and jihad in the way of Allah are continuous, under those with authority among the Muslims, the righteous and wicked among them, until the establishment of the Hour. Nothing invalidates or rescinds them

- Why are hajj and jihad brought together
 - Normally these are acts that you do with the khalifa
 - Ex: The Prophet ﷺ, Umar etc.
 - It is done under the banner of the leader
- This will remain a part of our sharia until the DOJ
 - Jihad, in its battle form, will continue to exist
 - It is not something which its existence can be denied or that will fade away
 - The idea that jihad is abrogated is incorrect
 - Its conditions may not be fulfilled but, it is still present
- Conditions of defensive jihad
 - the only condition is being under attack
 - The priority is self defense and protecting your life
 - However it must be under a leader
 - There is no vigilantism in islam
- Conditions of offensive jihad
 - Must come from the khalifa
 - Must have an ijaab/agreement and acceptance from the people
 - No such thing as compulsion or force (like the draft in America)
 - Must be built upon dawah and not destruction
- Evidence of dawah in islamic imperialism: Every battle had a routine
 - First you send a letter, gifts, build a relationship, etc.
 - The sahaba would be sent to the regions to do the work of dawah, formally
 - And if they did not accept, they would pay jizya
 - And if they did not want to pay jizya, it would escalate
- Did islam "spread by the sword"?
 - Asian countries found islam through trade
 - The muslims of iraq were defeated by the mongols, but eventually those mongols who converted brought islam back to asia
- Is it a problem is islam grew through military expansion?
 - Why would it be? Every campaign to exist has done so
 - We should accept it, but with a caveat: there was no oppression
- Islam has a track record of justice and mercy
 - Muslim conquests which are founded on being the recipients of violence first
 - Ex: Quds, Salahuddin letting them go

- Would be very hard to forgive them
- Would we realistically find it easy to forgive them and just let them pay jizya?
Probably not
- But that is the mercy of islam
- Islam does not in any way endorse ethnic cleansing
- Hypothetical society
 - Can you imagine a muslim khilafa, where non muslims are allowed to maintain their systems just with specific rules
 - This was how it was when there were khalifas
- Side story
 - Found in Tabari
 - Egypt, they were told they need to sacrifice an underage girl for water
 - Sacrificing children has always been a satanic ritual
 - Umar wrote two letters back
 - Put one in the river
 - And then the water started flowing
- Side story: Islam came to remove corruption, need to work on them and give them dawah
 - Rabii ibn Kaab Al Aslami, a slave, in Saad ibn Abi Waqas army to Qadisia
 - When they were negotiating, Saad chose Rabi as the spokesperson to the Persians
 - His clothes were tattered and his sword was without a sheath
 - They had decorated the room for the convey, and then he walked in
 - Rusdun said sit, Rabii said Im not here to sit Im here to talk
 - He says, Im a normal person but he sent me, no matter what you offer me I wont take it. Our Prophet ﷺ said to invite people toward 3 things:
 - From the injustice of all other ways of life to the justice of islam
 - From the tightness and confined nature of dunya to the ever expanding nature of akhira
 - From the idols to the oneness of god
 - The same people who are committing immoral deeds can also become muslim
- Islam has no concept of “holy wars” only dawah, it prioritizes peace/reconciliation
 - The rule of sulah/reconciliation is that you cannot remove places of worship
 - You leave people how they want to be
 - Unless you are recovering things that were taken from you by force to begin with (Ex: Hagia Sofia in Turkey)
- Brief mention of rules of war
 - Burn tree
 - Destroy places of worship
 - Destroy infrastructure (buildings, streets, libraries)

- Some say you can only go into the offensive if there is inkaan
 - Inkaan meaning likelihood of winning
 - If there is no inkaan, that is not permissible
- The Prophet ﷺ said there will be a time where there is no jihad until the arrival of the Mehdi
- Jihad can NOT be motivated by power and manfaat/profit
 - Evidence in the downfall of various muslim reigns
 - Muslim reign over Spain/Andalus, castle built on the oppressive taxes of the poor
 - Muslim reign over Quds, castle got destroyed, mufti tells the story
 - Common pattern in their downfall is that they eventually slipped into some form of oppression, particularly through financial oppression
 - The ambition of manfaat ruins the blessings

What are the biggest factors for the decline of an advanced muslim khalifa/society besides financial oppression?

Permissibility of being in a non muslim army 4/8 @ 13:30

- Imam Abu Hanifa
 - Muhammad Abu Yusuf, his student, found Imam Abu Hanifa at the age of 9
 - And every day he would bring home a few dinar for his dad
 - His dad then follows him, and finds out hes sitting at Abu Hanifas halaqa
 - He grabs his son
 - Abu Hanifa says relax, and the father says we are not like you, you are wealthy
 - Deen doesn't grow because of perfect systems but because of grit and determination
 - I see a day will come where your son will be sitting on the seats of kings and he will be enjoying desserts.
 - Then the father laughs and says why are you making a mockery out of me
- Abu Yusuf stayed with him until his death
 - A day came when he was sitting with other kings and they brought faloodaj
 - Mother look, faloodaj sitting with kings
 - The mother cries. That crazy man spoke the truth
- However Abu Yusuf took the position the government wanted
 - He said, this was my teachers ijthadd
 - He still remained apart of the madhab but he disagreed with him often
- Allah ﷻ gave the madhabs qubool, and two ijthadds can be correct at the same time

Ch 19: Faith in the Angels

Ch 19: Faith in the Angels

Date Covered: 4/9 @ 1350

We have faith in the noble recording angels, for Allah has appointed them over us as guardians. We have faith in the angel of death charged with seizing the souls of those in the worlds.

- This information is clearly brought in the Quran, but the existence of angels is not limited to this
 - We have yaqeen in the matters of angels
- Hamlat ul arsh
 - Jibreel, mikaeel, etc
- We believe that angels
 - Are genderless
 - Cannot be disobedient to Allah
- They serve different functions
 - They bring adhab
 - They bring rizq
 - They bring wahi
 - They do not disobey those functions
 - They were given the tasks they were for a reason
- About Mikaeel
 - He's like HR dept lol
 - In a mawquf narration (sahaba narrates) that Mikaeel is like the controller
 - Mikaeel either collects the souls himself or sends other angels
 - His powers are unclear
 - When he went to collect Musa's soul, Musa slapped him
 - When he went to the Prophet ﷺ, he waited at the Prophet ﷺ's door and asked for permission
 - He looked to Jibreel, who said Allah ﷻ is waiting to greet you
- We do not believe the angels to be helpers but creations
 - The existence of angels is just to show us nidham
 - Everything has a system and is precisely measured

Ch 20:

Punishment in

the Grave and it

Blessings

Ch 20: Punishment in the Grave and its Blessings

Date Covered: 4/9 @ 1357, 4/20 @ 1330

We have faith in the punishment of the grave for those who deserve it and the questioning in the grave by the two angels, Munkar and Nakir, about one's Lord, religion, and prophet, as has come in reports from the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, and from the companions, may Allah be pleased with them.

- There is no difference of opinion on the grave being either a punishment or a garden of jannah
 - Even the Prophet ﷺ sought refuge from its punishment
 - Hadith: The Prophet ﷺ walked by a graveyard and said he could hear them being punished
 - There are some groups (ex. Mutazzilites) who say that kabr/ the grave does not have a punishment and that it is a transition period, but that is completely incorrect
- The adhaab of kabr is well established in the deen of islam
 - Book rec: Ar Ruh by Ibn Al Qayyim
 - 3 tiers quran, hadith, and sahaba
 - One person asked, why do you turn pale when you talk about the grave? He answered because it is the first stage in the akhirah, and if you succeed there you can hope to succeed after it
- Story of Amr ibn Al Aas
 - Context: Known for his leadership, Fatih al Misir/ the conqueror of Misir. He lived a long life after the khalifas, into Ali's. Played a pivotal role in supporting Muawiyya. Was also in the same family as Uthman. He was the one who asked the Prophet ﷺ who he loved the most.
 - I've seen 3 phases of my life. The first I hated the Prophet ﷺ, the second I loved him, and the third was a fitna
 - Longer statement available online
- Narrations of the grave
 - Avoidable sins lead to the punishment of the grave
 - The Prophet ﷺ narrates that he could feel the rasha being opened in the grave
- Questioning of the grave is established in the Quran
 - The punishment is established through tawaatur
 - Umar narrates about Munkar and Nakir. He asked the Prophet ﷺ, when they come to ask me will I be in the same state I am in today?
 - The Prophet ﷺ answered, you will be exactly how you are now, and in that moment Allah جل جلاله will give you life
 - Umar responded then I am not worried, I have yaqeen

- Analogy: waking up in the middle of the night
 - The person's mind will not answer, but their heart
 - Whatever is the lord of your heart
 - Rububiya is whatever decreases your heart feels lost and whatever increases your heart feels happy
 - To a lot of people now, their rabb is actually money
 - If the heart is established in its faith, then the questions will be easy
- Dua: Give me the strength to answer questions when they are asked
 - Our main exam is these questions
 - Some say that shamail is wajib, because if we don't know his traits how will we recognize him?
 - Similarly, the questions of the grave
- We believe in all that comes in the reports of the Prophet ﷺ

Side Stories

- Umar would visit his governors homes
 - Umar asked Saad ibn Abi Waqas to step away
 - People kept saying things about him, do you want to live in Iraq when these are the people you are leading
 - Saad was mustajaab ad dua. Made dua that the man's tongue sags, and when he begs for death do not give it to him
- Aasim says, I saw Umar (his father) in a dream how his questioning was
 - Who is your lord: my lord is Allah ﷻ, whose your lord?
 - The angels went back up
 - Then he asked, how far did you descend from? They said the 7th heaven. He said, I came down 6ft how can I forget

The grave is either one of the meadows of Paradise or one of the pits of Hellfire

- When the righteous person is buried, it asks for permission from Allah ﷻ if it can honor them, and when Allah ﷻ answers yes, it widens
 - In a dream: ? someone saw their father in a dream, and his neighbors in the grave said they were benefiting from his window into jannah
- People in their graves can feel and hear the presence of those who visit them
 - But they cannot speak, eat, or respond
 - The benefit of reading actually extends to everyone around them
- Hadith
 - There is no person who passes by a grave and knew him in his life, that he responds to him
 - If you were to see what I saw, you would do anything for jannah

- Side topic: the kashf of Imam Abu Hanifa
 - Imam Abu Hanifa, they say, had great kashf
 - Allah ﷻ has given certain people kashf/sight of things other people don't have
 - A person whose heart is so pure, even sitting with impure people is a form of sabr for them
 - People who can tell what you are struggling with
 - He made dua for Allah ﷻ to take his kashf from him because it made it hard for him to go in public
- Every creation of Allah ﷻ finds fulfilment in serving Allah ﷻ
 - Every creation was created for servitude
 - The grave serves us
 - The windows of jannah open up
 - The body of the soul is in the illiyyin
- The earth prays for/seeks refuge from us
 - When the person who prays, every part he walks on asks Allah ﷻ to be buried inside of me. The opposite is also said
 - Many narrations exist
- The Prophet ﷺ said we soften our hearts by remembering the graves
 -
- Question: Why will people who are comfortable in the grave be afraid of resurrection?
 - The hisaab of the grave is built upon the deeds not on how they dealt with people
 - People can become bankrupt on the DOJ by people coming to collect their rights
 - It is also not that people are anxious about their hisaab but also that they are afraid of the day itself
 - A munafiq might find that they are comfortable in the grave but not entering jannah on the DOJ
- The life of the barzakh / Can the dead hear?
 - Not agreed upon what exactly they hear
 - And that how much they hear can differ case by case (ie prophets)
 - They cannot speak, eat
 - They have no bodily functions
 - Every function enjoyed in the grave is primarily enjoyed by the soul
 - We say salam ahlul kubur for a reason, they can hear us
- Using the word dead for those in their graves
 - The earth does not eat the bodies of Prophets and their life in the grave is different
 - They're not technically dead, so it's not really accurate to say they are

- The argument of being alive can be made for shuhada
 - For a shaheed, their body and soul is not in the barzakh the same way as other souls

Ch 21: Faith in the Last Day

Ch 21: Faith in the Last Day

Date Covered: 4/20 @ 1410

We have faith in the Resurrection and the recompense for actions on the Day of Resurrection, the presentation of deeds, the reckoning, and the reading of the book of deeds, the reward and punishment, the Bridge over Hell (alsirat),¹¹⁴ and the Scale (al-mizan).

Station of Bi'tha

- The body finds the soul
- Hadith
 - A man from before our ummah, passed away. Asked his sons to cut him up in pieces because he lived disobediently and to throw him in the ocean so that he can avoid the punishment of the grave
 - When he meets Allah ﷻ, Allah ﷻ asks him. Out of fear of you, that if they put me in the grave you would punish me
 - Then Allah ﷻ forgives him

Station of Aradh

- Aradh
 - Means presentation
- Presenting to Allah ﷻ one by one
 - You will come to Allah ﷻ as furadha
 - Analogy: crossing the border and being interrogated
 - You are going to come to Allah ﷻ one by one
- Some people will have free-passes
 - Ex: the person who makes wudhu properly
 - Ex: The person who makes sujood
 - Allah ﷻ will recognize the bodies
 - Criminals will be recognized as well
- Ayah: "They will find every deed that they did to be physically present"
 - Every salah is graded
 - The prayer itself is taken up as a physical object
 - Some will be beautiful, while others will be like dirty rags
 - And in the grave, a beautiful image will appear, and the angels will ask, and it will say I am the quran that kept him awake at night
- Hadhira
 - Meaning physical and tangible
 - And people will try to run away from their sins

Station of Sirat

- A thin bridge which you will only survive if you were on Sirat Al Mustakeem in dunya
 - The people who will be comfortable are the ones who are already comfortable
- The DOJ can feel like a couple hours or 70k years
 - Some people, even as they're waiting will feel like they are in a waiting lounge

Station of Mizan

Paradise and Hellfire are two creations that never end, nor perish.116 For Allah Almighty created Paradise and Hellfire before the rest of creation, then He created people for them. Whoever He wills enters Paradise due to His grace, and whoever He wills enters Hellfire due to His justice. Everyone acts in accordance with what is decreed for him, becoming that for which he was created

- Jannah and jahannam are confirmed existences
 - Their existences are not denied or debated
 - Fundamental beliefs
- Jannah has gates
- Jahannam
 - When it was first created it was a lighter fire, and after a long time it became yellow, and then orange, and then red, and then a dark fire
- Jannah and jahannam are creations of Allah ﷻ and thus they serve him
 - They serve the purpose they were created for without compromise
- Other points
 - Entrance into jannah will be based on mercy and entrance into jahannam will be based on justice
 - Allah ﷻ's anger is not a reactive one, Allah ﷻ does not react rather he has set principles and he acts on them
- The names of people who will enter either/or are already decided
 - The qadr of Allah ﷻ regarding jannah and jahannam is closer to knowledge
 - See previous notes on qadr and free will
 - Our ability to do good and evil is within our own free will

Good and evil have both been decreed for the servants.

Ch 22:

Capability is Accompanied by Deeds

Ch 22: Capability is Accompanied by Deeds

Date Covered: 4/30 @ 1348

The ability required for an action is from divine facilitation, which cannot be ascribed to a created being, along with the action itself. As for ability from the view of health, capacity, capability, and sound means, it is before the action itself, and what is related to these are addressed, as it was said by the Exalted, 'Allah holds no soul responsible except within its capacity.'

- Istithaa
 - Word is on the scale istifaal
 - Meaning the capacity to do good
 - Different from tawfiq, which is when a person both has the ability and the guidance
- A lack of istithaa removes your capacity to accrue sins
 - A person is not held liable for things that they are not capable of fulfilling
 - If Allah ﷻ makes a person incapable, then that is not something for them to grieve over
- If you have not been given something (ex: health, wealth) it should be a source of motivation for you
 - Tabuk, the people who could not give anything. They had no money to spend in the path of Allah ﷻ. But their emotions were so great that they got the reward anyway
 - TS 1352 Abdullah ibn Mubarrak, saw an angel in a dream. Asked how many people's hajj was accepted. Angel says no one, except one. Angels responded saying it was the person who didn't go for hajj. Then he went to the man's house, asked him. The man said I was saving up for years for hajj, and I prepared. We started cooking/barbecuing in the house. And the smell went into the neighbors house and she sent her child to ask if they could have some. The neighbor was a pregnant mother, no husband. She said she's been craving lahm and hasn't eaten it for the last 3 years. He took it and gave it all to her. And he walks away. AiM comes to tell him with tears in his eyes that his hajj was accepted. No istithaa but still accepted
 - Sometimes just because we don't have the istithaa doesn't mean we cant get the reward
 - Side point: etiquette of giving is that you don't make them feel belittled
 - Sometimes the feeling of not being able to do it is enough to be rewarded for it
- Examples where there is no istithaa
 - Childhood
 - Insanity

- Poor health
- Depends on the act
- Usage of the limbs
- Only Allah ﷻ can give a person health
- Side reminder: visit sick people. Gives them so much benefit
 - Story: Brother was sick. Sh Abdul Aziz would visit him and he said that was what kept him alive
 - You can never get too big to serve people, more people should be benefiting from you
 - People should know us as the first responders
 - Simple actions can be the biggest dawah, like visiting the sick and attending janazaha
- One cannot say that they have capability but not responsibility
 - A person must attempt if they have capacity
 - They should not use the excuse that they are afraid
- Where there is istithaa there is liability
 - Now you have to do the deed
 - Where there is more autonomy there is more liability
 - Allah ﷻ does not burden us with an amal which is more than what is within our capacity
- Side topic: sexuality
 - Allah ﷻ has given everyone the istithaa to resist something, especially knowing that it is haram
 - We all have to figure out our own vices
 - "I'm struggling" not "I can't stop"
 - Sabr al maasiya, is the kind of sabr which exists against sins
 - In islam we believe that things are haram for a reason, and that what Allah ﷻ makes haram doesn't always need an explanation
 - Allah ﷻ is Al-Hakim, and he only decrees rules with wisdom
 - Sometimes people who have different preferences will try to make the argument that it is unjust. How do we respond to that?
 - Story: Gay guy came to Mufti and said he's been struggling with it and nobody knows about it. I wanted help. Told him he might be a wali of Allah ﷻ. Wants to get married and have kids. His ability to hold off on their sins is their akhirah.
- Tawfiq comes from Allah ﷻ
 - Even the Prophet ﷺ did not have power to give tawfiq
 - Guidance is something that comes from Allah ﷻ
- Side topic: Silatur rahim
 - Building ourselves to be people who inspire tawfiq in others

- We need to establish it in ourselves
- People should feel uncomfortable sinning in front of us
- It's good to be relatable, but not to the point we lose our purpose
- The most definitive truth is displayed in a believer. Displaying the quran in our hearts is the firmest way to uphold haqq
- But also don't want to compromise our principles to become closer to our audience
- What is the difference between tawfiq and hidaya
 - Hidaya is like the nucleus
 - You need hidaya in order to truly benefit
 - Ex: non muslims who have great tawfiq to do good things
 - They don't have the foundation of faith, thats what hidaya is

The actions of the servants are creations of Allah and are earned by the servants.

Allah Almighty does not hold them responsible unless they are capable, and they are not capable except for what they are responsible for. It is the explanation of the phrase, 'There is no movement or might but by Allah.'

- La hawla wala quwwata illa billa
 - This is a tafsir of this phrase

We say there is no stratagem of anyone, nor transformation of anyone, nor movement of anyone in disobedience to Allah except by enablement from Allah. None has the power to perform obedience to Allah and be firm upon it except by the facilitation of Allah ﷻ.

- Hiila
 - Meaning strategy, trick
- Tahawul
 - Meaning change
- Haraka
 - Meaning movement
- There is no way to turn away from Allah ﷻ except with his help
 - The power of change only comes from Allah ﷻ
 - We should also be asking Allah ﷻ for help moving away from sins
- Both resistance to sins and spiritual growth
 - The power of restraint comes from Allah ﷻ, he is the one who gives people the ability to restrain themselves
 - The change that one pursues cannot be done in the silo of spiritual growth
 - The power comes from Allah ﷻ

- Tawfiq for good and quwwa for restraint

All things occur by the will of Allah the Exalted, His knowledge, His decree, and His providence.¹²⁷ His will overpowers all other wills, and His decree overpowers all other stratagems.¹²⁸ He does whatever He wills, and He is never unjust,¹²⁹ 'He will not be questioned about what He does, but they will be questioned.

- Allah ﷻ is the only power whose power does not lead to destruction
- Not questioning Allah ﷻ
 - None of his decisions can or should be questioned
 - When we believe he is Al-Hakim, we do not question any of his decisions

Ch 23: Allah جلاله

Answers Dua

Ch 23: Allah ﷻ Answers Dua

Date Covered: 5/12 @ 1440

In the supplication of the living and their acts of charity are benefits for the dead.

- The dead benefit from
 - Dua
 - Charity
 - Intentions on good deeds
 - (possibly) physical ibadah as long as they are not fard (ex. recitation of quran, umrah, hajj)
- The dead cannot benefit from
 - Fasting
 - Fard prayers

Allah Almighty responds to supplications and fulfills needs.

- skipped

He controls all things and nothing has any control over Him. None can be independent of Allah for as much as the blink of an eye. Whoever considers himself independent of Allah for as much as the blink of an eye has committed unbelief and has become among the people of perdition.

- Whoever thinks they are independent from Allah ﷻ at any moment has committed kufr
 - Dua: do not leave me to rely on myself
 - The power of making the right step comes from Allah ﷻ

He becomes angered and becomes pleased, yet not like anyone else besides Him.

- Allah ﷻ's anger is his justice
 - A person who has no anger has no capacity to be fair and just

Ch 24: Praise for the Companions

Ch 24: Praise for the Companions

Date Covered: 5/12 @ 1450

We love the companions of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him. We do not exaggerate in our love for any of them, nor do we disown any of them. We hate those who hate them or who mention them without good, for we do not mention them except with good. Love for them is a part of religion, faith, and spiritual excellence, and hatred for them is unbelief, hypocrisy, and transgression.

- Knowing and praising the sahaba is a part of our aqeedah
 - There are entire hadith collections praising them
 - It's actually a part of our creed
 - Side bar: the Prophet ﷺ praising Abu Bakr
- We dislike anyone who dislikes any sahaba
 - When you hate a sahaba, you earn the laana of the Prophet ﷺ

We affirm the Caliphate after the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, first went to Abu Bakr al-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, having virtue and priority over all others in the Muslim nation.

Then, it was for 'Umar ibn al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him.

Then, it was for 'Uthman, may Allah be pleased with him.

Then, it was for 'Ali ibn Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him.

They are the righteous Caliphs and guided leaders.

The ten who were named by the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, as being promised with Paradise, we testify that they are in Paradise due to what was testified for them by the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, and his statements are true.

They are Abu Bakr, 'Umar, 'Uthman, 'Ali, Talhah, Al-Zubayr, Sa'd, Sa'id, 'Abd alRaḥmān ibn 'Awf, and Abu 'Ubaydah ibn Al-Jarraḥ who was the trustee of this nation, may Allah be pleased with them all.

Whoever speaks well of the companions of the Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings be upon him, and his wives, pure of any defilement, and his sanctified progeny, he is innocent of any hypocrisy.

The scholars of the first generation who preceded us and those after them among the successors, the people of virtue, tradition, understanding, and insight, they are not mentioned but in a gracious way. Whoever mentions them in an evil way, he is on a path different from their path

- There is a level of adherence we keep to following the previous scholars

Ch 25: No Virtue of Saints over Prophets

Ch 25: No Virtue of Saints over Prophets

Date Covered: 5/15 @ 1033

We do not prefer any of the saints of this nation over any of the prophets, upon them be peace. We say that a single prophet is better than all the saints put together.

- We distinguish the prophets and do not assign prophetic virtue to anyone besides the prophets
 - Even the Prophets are given a level of separation, in the sense that they do not have powers that Allah ﷻ has and we do not worship them
 - No one that comes after can be given that same level of respect
- Establishing a level of attachment to our history through our aqeedah
 - There is still so much to learn, and not all topics need formal teaching
- Side bar: Who to learn about
 - The prophets
 - The sahaba
 - The scholars
- Lesson: Allah ﷻ's system is unique, he does not need us
 - TS 1043
- The Prophet ﷺ is greater than all of the awliya

We have faith in what has come of their miracles and what has been authenticated in their narrations from trustworthy narrators.

- Mu'jizat
 - Meaning miracles of prophets
 - Them making us feel dumbfounded and incapable is what they're supposed to do
 - Ex: splitting the moon, water from his hands, food miracles etc
 - Denying the mujiza which are referenced in Quran make a person kaaafir
 - Denying the mujiza of narration make a person a fasiq
- Karaama
 - Miracles of non-prophets
 - They do take place in the Quran (Khidr, Luqman, Mahdi)
 - Revelation ended with the prophets but miracles did not
 - Karaama takes place where someone believes completely that Allah ﷻ will take care of them
- Lesson: We should be cautious to claim things as karaamat because they can actually make a mockery of religion
 - When hearing peoples stories we should neither be very critical nor quick to believe

- Some people abuse and manipulate the existence of miracles
- But that does not mean that they do not exist
- Muttar
 - A person who turns to another with extreme desperation

Sometimes people tend to fall for miracles a little too easily and it actually leads to shakier faith in Allah ﷻ. How do you re-orient them?

- Not really a problem in our current society
 - Americans tend to reject even hadith
 - They don't believe in things easily
 - To the extent that we have to be cautious in what we speak about
 - Should prioritize accordingly, can speak about stories but within boundaries
- Ask them about the situation in their own life and what leads to their tendency

How do we talk to people who are quick to brush off anything they deem as not legitimate enough (like stories of the pious predecessors and sahaba)? Especially if they're not a scholar or even a student, they just

Ch 26: Faith in Signs of the Hour

Ch 26: Faith in Signs of the Hour

Date Covered: 5/15 @ 1117

We have faith in the signs of the Hour, such as the appearance of the False Messiah (al-Dajjal), and the descent from the heavens of Jesus the son of Mary, upon him be peace. We have faith in the rising of the sun from the West and in the emergence of the Beast from its place in the earth.

- We believe in
 - The signs of the last hour
 - The appearance of dajjal
 - The return of Isa AS as a member of the Prophet ﷺ's ummah
 - The rising of the sun from the west
 - The emergence of the daaba
- TS 1120
 - Story of sajda sahu if you say durood for hanafis
- Some would say that failing to believe in these signs takes a person out of the folds of islam

Ch 27: Falsehood of Soothsayers and Fortunetellers

Ch 27: Falsehood of Soothsayers and Fortunetellers

Date Covered: 5/15 @ 1125

We do not believe in soothsayers and fortunetellers, nor whoever claims anything against the Book, the Sunnah, and the consensus of the Muslim nation.

- A form of shirk
 - Should not indulge in any kind of activity like this
 - Fortunetelling etc.

Ch 28: Unity

Ch 28: Unity

Date Covered: 5/15 @ 1127

We regard unity as truth and what is right, and sectarianism as deviation and punishment.

- Hadith: Whoever seeks to be alone will go to jahannam alone
 - The jama'a and the shiar of the deen should not be compromised
 - Unity does not need to be everyone being exactly the same
 - Unity is people coming together when it is necessary
- Sectarianism is a form of deviation and deserving of punishment
 - A person does not need to be told to stay away

The religion of Allah on earth and in the heavens is one, and it is the religion of Islam. Allah ﷻ Almighty said, 'Verily, the religion with Allah is Islam,'¹⁵⁴ And the Almighty said, 'I am pleased with Islam as your religion.' ¹⁵⁵ It is between exaggeration and belittlement, between comparing the attributes of Allah to creation and negating them, between fatalism and unrestricted free will, and between guarantee and despair.

- Our religion exists in between aman and iyaas

This is our religion and what we take as our creed, inwardly and outwardly. We disown before Allah Almighty all those who oppose what we have mentioned and clarified. We ask Allah the Exalted to keep us firm upon faith, seal our lives with it, and to protect us from various desires, sectarian opinions, and the doctrines of rejection, such as anthropomorphists (alMushabbihah),¹⁵⁷ the rationalists (al-Mu'tazilah),¹⁵⁸ those who deny the attributes of Allah (al-Jahmiyyah),¹⁵⁹ the fatalists (al-Jabriyah),¹⁶⁰ the deniers of providence (al-Qadariyah),¹⁶¹ and others who oppose the united community and have made a pact of misguidance. We are innocent of them, for they are, to us, astray and ruined. And in Allah alone is protection and Guidance.

- Mushabbiha
 - People who put human like attributes on Allah ﷻ
- Al Jahmiyya
 - TS 1134
- Al Jabariyaa
- Al Qadariya
 - The ones who believe that decree is forced upon us and thus we are not liable for it

Conclusion

- Without Allah ﷻ, we are not protected from falling into these tricks of Shaytan
- Creed is meant to reassure the heart. It is a thing of the heart not the mind and if we don't interact with it with precision we will lose ourselves
- The whole purpose of aqeedah is ma'rifa of Allah